

ENGLISH FOR BOOKKEEPING, ACCOUNTS, AND PAYROLL TEAMS

Bookkeeping & Payroll English

Explain the figures. Preserve the evidence.



Phil Stilwell

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For bookkeepers, accounts payable and receivable clerks, payroll assistants, and finance-support staff discussing records, exceptions, and approvals.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight record-based conversations build precise financial English: invoice matching, customer receipts, bank reconciliation, time exceptions, payroll previews, payment approvals, period-close handoffs, and traceable corrections.

01 Matching an invoice to its supporting records 4

A184: two lamps without a receiving record | Explain an invoice-matching exception by comparing three records and requesting the missing evidence without assuming a completed delivery.

02 Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances 13

The money arrived; the invoice allocation did not | Acknowledge an identified receipt while separating total account arithmetic from unresolved invoice-level allocation.

03 Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference 22

A July posting helps explain June | Describe a plausible timing difference with the correct direction and dates while keeping the broader reconciliation incomplete.

04 Requesting evidence for time exceptions 31

A missing clock-out is not a known finish time | Request evidence for a time-record exception while distinguishing the roster, employee recollection, and confirmed actual work time.

05 Explaining a payroll preview 40

Same gross pay, fifty dollars less net | Explain the arithmetic of two payroll previews while separating a visible deduction from its unverified supporting authority.

06 Making approval status unambiguous 49

Seven approved items, no released batch | Distinguish invoice approval, proposed batch membership, payment release, and an excluded exception in a concise status handoff.

07 Handing over a period-close review 58

Nine checks done, one period question open | Hand over an unresolved cutoff question with its amount, dates, review owner, and unapproved posting status intact.

08 Correcting records while preserving the trail 67

A duplicate entry, not a recovered payment | Correct an overstatement by distinguishing a confirmed tracker duplication from unposted ledger changes and unproven cash movements.

Communication field notes	3
Three more workplace conversations	76
Answers and explanations	85
Fast-access phrase pages	104
Vocabulary index	106
Sources and publication notes	114

Say what the record establishes.

A number can be correct while the explanation around it is wrong. Distinguish a receipt from its allocation, a proposed batch from a released payment, and a duplicate tracker entry from an actual duplicate payment.

Keep the document chain visible

Identify the invoice, order, receiving record, and checked quantity separately. An unexplained mismatch calls for supporting evidence. A possible second delivery does not become a documented receipt because it would make the figures agree.

"A184 and P61 list twelve lamps; R9 records ten. We need support for the remaining two."

Separate arithmetic from status

A receipt can reduce the overall account position while invoice allocation remains unresolved. A deduction can explain a net-pay difference without its authority being established. State what the calculation shows and what still needs review.

"Net pay is fifty dollars lower because deductions are fifty higher; the supporting record is pending."

Name the exact approval stage

Item approval, inclusion in a proposed batch, and release are different states. A reviewer returning at a particular time does not guarantee approval then. Keep excluded items and missing evidence visible in the handoff.

"Seven invoices have recorded approval; the proposed batch has not been released."

Correct claims as well as figures

An inaccurate message can outlive a corrected spreadsheet. Identify the specific false claim and replace it with the verified finding. Keep the original record and authorized correction trail according to the actual workplace process.

"One duplicate tracker entry is confirmed; no duplicate payment or recovery has been established."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All entities, figures, records, deadlines, and approvals are fictional. This is English practice, not accounting, tax, payroll, employment-law, or financial advice. Follow the applicable rules, professional review, privacy safeguards, and organizational controls. The exercises do not authorize posting entries, changing time records, applying deductions, allocating receipts, or releasing payments. Internal review deadlines do not determine employee pay rights. Numerical explanations use only the stated facts.

A184: two lamps without a receiving record

A Read the situation

Explain an invoice-matching exception by comparing three records and requesting the missing evidence without assuming a completed delivery.

Fictional supplier Alder bills twelve desk lamps on invoice A184. Purchase order P61 lists twelve lamps, but receiving record R9 lists ten. The remaining two may relate to another delivery; no second receiving record is available. Accounts payable clerk Mina asks purchasing colleague Joel to investigate the missing support. No complete match, payment approval, supplier overcharge, or confirmed second delivery has been established.

PEOPLE / Mina: Accounts payable clerk | Joel: Purchasing colleague

A MATCHING EXCEPTION IS A QUESTION, NOT AN ACCUSATION

A clear query names the three records and the exact difference. Keep a possible explanation conditional until evidence supports it. This lets the colleague investigate efficiently without changing the receiving record, blaming the supplier, or treating the invoice as approved.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does invoice A184 bill?

A Twelve desk lamps

C Two replacement lamps

B Ten archive boxes

D A confirmed second delivery only

2. What does receiving record R9 show?

A Ten lamps

C No delivery at all

B Twelve lamps

D An approved payment

3. What is known about the remaining two?

A They definitely arrived yesterday

C They have already been paid twice

B They prove Alder overcharged

D A second delivery is possible but unsupported by another record

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

accounts payable

Records and processes concerning amounts owed to suppliers; abbreviated AP.

IN USE raise an accounts payable query

supplier invoice

Supplier document requesting payment for stated goods or services.

IN USE identify the supplier invoice

purchase order

Order document specifying requested items and terms; abbreviated PO.

IN USE match the purchase order

receiving record

Evidence recording goods received under the stated process.

IN USE check the receiving record

three-way match

Comparison of invoice, order, and receipt information.

IN USE investigate a three-way match exception

matching exception

Difference preventing the required records from agreeing.

IN USE document the matching exception

invoice quantity

Number of units billed on the invoice.

IN USE verify invoice quantity

order quantity

Number of units requested on the purchase order.

IN USE compare order quantity

received quantity

Number of units documented as received.

IN USE preserve received quantity

supporting document

Record providing evidence for an entry or decision.

IN USE request the supporting document

line item

Separately identified entry on a transaction document.

IN USE check the line item

unit price

Price stated for one item or unit.

IN USE verify the unit price

Precision check

A184 bills twelve lamps and P61 orders twelve, but R9 supports ten received. The difference is two lamps. The agreement between invoice and order does not remove the mismatch with the receiving record.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

supplier account

Record grouping transactions for a particular vendor.

IN USE identify the supplier account

invoice reference

Identifier for a supplier bill.

IN USE quote the invoice reference

order reference

Identifier linking a transaction to the purchase request.

IN USE retain the order reference

receipt reference

Identifier for the receiving evidence.

IN USE include the receipt reference

quantity variance

Difference between compared unit counts.

IN USE explain the quantity variance

partial delivery

Delivery of fewer than all ordered units.

IN USE investigate a partial delivery

unmatched balance

Portion not yet supported by the required matching evidence.

IN USE explain the unmatched balance

query status

Current state of an unresolved inquiry.

IN USE preserve query status

payment hold

Status preventing payment pending the relevant process.

IN USE distinguish a payment hold

approval evidence

Record establishing the permission actually given.

IN USE obtain approval evidence

overbilling

Billing more than is properly chargeable under the relevant facts.

IN USE avoid assuming overbilling

document chain

Linked records supporting a transaction from order to receipt and bill.

IN USE preserve the document chain

Precision check

Another delivery is possible, not confirmed. Request its receiving support if it exists. Do not rewrite R9 to twelve, accuse Alder of overbilling, or describe a complete match or payment approval before the missing evidence is resolved.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE INVOICE

"I am querying Alder invoice A184."

STATE THE BILLED QUANTITY

"The invoice bills twelve desk lamps."

STATE THE RECEIPT EVIDENCE

"Receiving record R9 lists ten."

KEEP A HYPOTHESIS CONDITIONAL

"They may relate to another delivery."

NAME THE ORDER

"It relates to purchase order P61."

STATE THE ORDER QUANTITY

"The purchase order also lists twelve."

DESCRIBE THE DIFFERENCE

"Two lamps are not supported by the available receiving record."

REQUEST THE MISSING SUPPORT

"Can you locate a second receiving record?"

Also lists

Shows agreement between two documents without implying a complete match.

Not supported by

Identifies an evidence gap rather than asserting the goods never arrived.

May relate to

Keeps a possible explanation conditional.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID CLAIMING A MATCH

"The three records do not yet fully agree."

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"This difference does not by itself establish overbilling."

REQUEST A TRACEABLE REPLY

"Please include A184, P61, and R9 in the response."

KEEP THE QUERY OPEN

"The remaining two still need support."

PRESERVE THE ORIGINAL RECORD

"I will not change R9 to match the invoice."

SEPARATE APPROVAL

"We have not established payment approval."

LIMIT THE STATEMENT

"Ten are documented as received in the available record."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT ACTION

"Please check the delivery evidence and report what is actually documented."

By itself

Limits the conclusion that can be drawn from one mismatch.

Documented as

Attributes a quantity to its evidence source.

Do not yet fully agree

Keeps the matching exception visible without declaring fraud or final resolution.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary is accurate?

- A** A second receipt has already been found
- B** A184 and P61 list twelve; R9 records ten; support for two is missing
- C** All three documents confirm twelve
- D** Alder definitely supplied only ten in total

2. Which request moves the query forward?

- A** Please locate any receiving record for the remaining two lamps
- B** Please change R9 to twelve without evidence
- C** Please mark the invoice paid now
- D** Please accuse Alder of intentional overbilling

3. What does may relate to another delivery mean?

- A** The supplier has admitted an error
- B** Payment has been approved
- C** It is a possible explanation requiring support
- D** The delivery is confirmed

4. Which reference belongs to the receiving record?

- A** A184
- B** P61
- C** An invented second reference
- D** R9

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

A184: two lamps without a receiving record

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

received quantity / unmatched balance / supporting document / quantity variance / document chain / overbilling / query status / approval evidence / partial delivery / matching exception

- 01 **Mina:** Joel, could you check Alder A184? The invoice and order both say twelve lamps, but the receipt support doesn't cover all twelve.
- 02 **Joel:** Let us walk through the ¹ _____. Which purchase order and receiving record are you comparing, and what does each document actually show?
- 03 **Mina:** It's order P61 and receiving record R9. P61 and A184 show twelve; R9 shows ten.
- 04 **Joel:** Then we have a ² _____, not a complete match. The invoice agreeing with the order does not establish that all twelve are documented as received.
- 05 **Mina:** Could the other two have come separately? I haven't found another receiving record, so I can't confirm that.
- 06 **Joel:** That is the right distinction. A ³ _____ could explain the first record, but we need evidence before saying the rest arrived separately.
- 07 **Mina:** Please check with receiving and keep A184, P61, and R9 together in the query.
- 08 **Joel:** I will request the missing ⁴ _____, if one exists, and use A184, P61, and R9 in the inquiry. I will not invent a second receipt reference.
- 09 **Mina:** Someone suggested changing R9 to twelve because it would match the order. That would hide the gap.
- 10 **Joel:** Agreed. The ⁵ _____ in R9 should remain ten unless the appropriate evidence and correction process establish something different. The query must preserve what we currently know.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Mina:** Does this prove an overcharge? I need to answer a colleague without accusing the supplier on incomplete evidence.
- 12 **Joel:** We should not assert ⁶ _____ from this alone. We have a gap in the available receipt evidence, and another delivery remains possible. That is different from proving an improper charge.
- 13 **Mina:** Then I'll say two unsupported by the available record, not definitely undelivered.
- 14 **Joel:** Yes. The ⁷ _____ is precise, while the cause remains open. It gives the receiving team a concrete question to investigate without deciding the outcome for them.
- 15 **Mina:** And this isn't a payment approval. We're asking for receiving evidence, not releasing an invoice.
- 16 **Joel:** Understood. We have not established ⁸ _____ for payment in this exchange. Locating a document and completing the relevant approval process are not interchangeable statements.
- 17 **Mina:** Please say whether you found the missing record. Handled wouldn't tell me whether the exception is resolved.
- 18 **Joel:** I will report the actual ⁹ _____. If support is still missing, the reply will say so and retain the two-lamp difference against the same document references.
- 19 **Mina:** I'll leave twelve billed and ordered, ten documented, two requiring support, possible second delivery unconfirmed.
- 20 **Joel:** That captures the ¹⁰ _____ in quantity terms. I will follow up on the evidence and keep any later conclusion tied to the records that support it.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. document chain | 2. matching exception | 3. partial delivery | 4. supporting document | 5. received quantity | 6. overbilling | 7. quantity variance | 8. approval evidence | 9. query status | 10. unmatched balance

Name the three records and the unresolved difference

F Say it

Complete the matching query without assuming a second receipt or payment approval.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

P61 / R9 / A184 / two

Clerk: "The supplier invoice is ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The purchase order is ² _____."

Clerk: "Receiving record ³ _____ lists ten."

Colleague: "Support for the remaining ⁴ _____ lamps is missing."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. A184 | 2. P61 | 3. R9 | 4. two

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the invoice-matching dialogue.
2. Read the three references and quantities aloud: A184 twelve, P61 twelve, R9 ten. Then read the request for evidence of the remaining two.
3. Complete the transfer, check the explained key, and reread the query without claiming either overbilling or a complete match.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The money arrived; the invoice allocation did not

A Read the situation

Acknowledge an identified receipt while separating total account arithmetic from unresolved invoice-level allocation.

Fictional customer Pine has invoice 410 for \$600 and invoice 411 for \$400. A \$600 receipt is identified as Pine's, but it contains no invoice reference. Both invoices remain open in the ledger pending allocation. Receivables clerk Ava asks customer contact Luis for the missing reference. The two invoices total \$1,000 and the identified receipt is \$600, leaving a \$400 net difference across these stated items; that arithmetic does not establish which invoice is settled.

PEOPLE / Luis: Customer contact | Ava: Receivables clerk

ACKNOWLEDGE THE MONEY BEFORE QUERYING ITS APPLICATION

A customer may hear open invoice as an accusation of nonpayment. Confirm the receipt that is actually identified, then explain the narrower allocation problem. An amount matching one invoice is a useful clue, not sufficient permission to assign the payment without the required reference.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is known about the \$600 receipt?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A It belongs to an unknown customer | B It proves invoice 411 was paid in full |
| C It belongs to Pine but lacks an invoice reference | D It is definitely allocated to invoice 410 |

2. What do the two invoices total?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| A \$1,600 | B \$1,000 |
| C \$600 | D \$400 |

3. Which invoice is confirmed settled?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Both automatically | B Neither while allocation is pending |
| C Invoice 410 because the amounts match | D Invoice 411 because it is smaller |

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

accounts receivable

Records of amounts due from customers; abbreviated AR.

IN USE check accounts receivable

customer account

Record grouping transactions for a particular customer.

IN USE identify the customer account

cash receipt

Record of money received.

IN USE acknowledge the cash receipt

receipt allocation

Assignment of received money to specified account items.

IN USE confirm receipt allocation

unallocated receipt

Received amount not yet assigned to particular items.

IN USE explain the unallocated receipt

invoice reference

Identifier showing which invoice a payment concerns.

IN USE request the invoice reference

remittance advice

Payment information explaining the items a payer intends to settle.

IN USE request remittance advice

open invoice

Invoice still shown as unsettled in the relevant ledger.

IN USE explain an open invoice

ledger

Organized accounting record of transactions and balances.

IN USE check the ledger

settlement

Application or completion that resolves the relevant amount due.

IN USE confirm invoice settlement

invoice-level balance

Unsettled amount associated with one particular invoice.

IN USE distinguish an invoice-level balance

account-level position

Combined position across the specified customer-account items.

IN USE explain the account-level position

Precision check

Invoices 410 and 411 total \$1,000. The identified \$600 receipt leaves a \$400 net difference across those stated items. Do not call the full \$1,000 unpaid without acknowledging the receipt, and do not claim invoice 411 is the confirmed remaining debt.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

net difference

Result after offsetting the stated amounts for comparison.

IN USE calculate the net difference

payer identity

Identification of the person or entity sending money.

IN USE verify payer identity

aging bucket

Group of outstanding balances classified within a specified age interval and date basis.

IN USE reconcile the aging buckets

matching amount

Figure equal to another amount but not necessarily linked to it.

IN USE distinguish a matching amount

allocation query

Request to establish where a receipt should be applied.

IN USE raise an allocation query

statement of account

Summary of relevant customer transactions and balances.

IN USE clarify the statement of account

credit balance

Account position representing an amount in the customer's favor under the relevant records.

IN USE verify a credit balance

overdue

Past the applicable due date, when that date is established.

IN USE avoid assuming overdue status

unapplied cash

Received funds awaiting application to the relevant items.

IN USE identify unapplied cash

days past due

Days elapsed after the applicable due date, measured at the specified aging date.

IN USE calculate days past due

allocation instruction

Direction identifying the intended application of a receipt.

IN USE record the allocation instruction

collection message

Communication seeking or discussing payment of amounts due.

IN USE correct a misleading collection message

Precision check

The \$600 receipt matches the amount of invoice 410, but its invoice reference is missing. Both invoices remain open pending allocation. Request the intended reference or remittance detail, and do not invent due dates, overdue status, or an authorized application.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE RECEIPT

"We have identified your \$600 receipt."

NAME THE INVOICES

"Invoice 410 is \$600 and invoice 411 is \$400."

AVOID A NONPAYMENT ACCUSATION

"I am not saying no money was received."

ASK FOR SUPPORTING DETAIL

"Could you provide the remittance advice?"

SEPARATE THE MISSING DETAIL

"The receipt does not include an invoice reference."

EXPLAIN THE LEDGER STATUS

"Both invoices remain open pending allocation."

REQUEST THE INTENDED APPLICATION

"Which invoice or invoices should this receipt be applied to?"

QUALIFY AN AMOUNT MATCH

"The receipt matches 410 in amount, but that does not confirm allocation."

Pending allocation

Explains why an invoice remains open despite an identified receipt.

Not saying no money

Corrects the broader misunderstanding before requesting more detail.

Matches in amount

Identifies similarity without claiming transaction linkage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE THE TOTAL

"The two invoice amounts total \$1,000."

KEEP THE LEVELS DISTINCT

"That is an account-level comparison, not a settled invoice allocation."

PRESERVE THE RECEIPT

"The allocation query does not erase the money received."

AVOID UNSUPPORTED CLOSURE

"I cannot mark 410 settled from the amount alone."

STATE THE NET ARITHMETIC

"After the identified \$600 receipt, the net difference is \$400."

AVOID AN OVERDUE CLAIM

"We have not supplied a due date here."

KEEP THE REQUEST FOCUSED

"We need the intended invoice reference, not another payment."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"Please confirm the allocation so the invoice records can be reviewed accurately."

After the identified receipt

Makes the basis of the net calculation explicit.

Which invoice or invoices

Allows a single or divided application without assuming either.

From the amount alone

Limits what a matching figure establishes.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement is accurate?

- A** \$600 was received from Pine, but invoice allocation is pending
- B** Pine has paid nothing
- C** Invoice 410 is definitely settled
- D** Invoice 411 is definitely overdue

2. What does the \$400 net difference establish?

- A** That the payment should be refunded
- B** The arithmetic across the stated invoices and receipt
- C** That invoice 411 alone is the confirmed unpaid item
- D** That no receipt exists

3. Which request is appropriate?

- A** Please pay another \$600 because the receipt has no reference
- B** Please accept that 410 is closed automatically
- C** Please invent a new due date
- D** Please confirm the intended invoice reference or remittance details

4. Why is a matching amount insufficient here?

- A** The receipt has no invoice reference and allocation remains pending
- B** Equal figures can never relate to the same transaction
- C** Invoice 410 does not exist
- D** Pine's identity is unknown

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The money arrived; the invoice allocation did not

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

matching amount / invoice-level balance / allocation query / overdue / customer account / cash receipt / allocation instruction / net difference / open invoice / remittance advice

- 01 **Luis:** Your message says both invoices are open, but we sent six hundred dollars. Has that payment been missed?
- 02 **Ava:** We've identified Pine's ¹ _____. The money isn't missing; the receipt lacks an invoice reference, so its application is unresolved.
- 03 **Luis:** Thank you. Which two invoices are on the message? I need to explain this to our accounts team.
- 04 **Ava:** Invoice 410 is \$600 and 411 is \$400. Each is still an ² _____ in the ledger while the receipt awaits allocation.
- 05 **Luis:** Six hundred is exactly the amount of 410. Why not close that one and leave 411 outstanding?
- 06 **Ava:** It's a ³ _____, but that doesn't confirm your intended application. We still need the reference rather than guessing from the figure.
- 07 **Luis:** What should I ask our team for? Another screenshot of the payment probably wouldn't answer your question.
- 08 **Ava:** Please ask for the ⁴ _____ or the intended invoice reference. It should say which invoice or invoices the payment was meant to settle.
- 09 **Luis:** Before I go back to them, the overall figures are a thousand in invoices and six hundred received. Is that right?
- 10 **Ava:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ across these stated items is \$400. That acknowledges the receipt without deciding which invoice it settles.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Luis:** So the remaining four hundred doesn't itself prove that 411 is the unpaid invoice. The allocation could affect the individual balances.
- 12 **Ava:** Correct. An ⁶ _____ depends on the actual application. We can't derive that application from the account-level difference alone.
- 13 **Luis:** Please say that in the next message. Otherwise someone may think you're asking us to send the same six hundred again.
- 14 **Ava:** I'll make it an ⁷ _____, not a duplicate payment request. We'll acknowledge the receipt and ask only for the missing application detail.
- 15 **Luis:** Are you also saying anything is overdue? I haven't seen a due date in the information we've discussed.
- 16 **Ava:** We haven't established ⁸ _____ status here. I won't add a deadline or collection claim that the supplied information doesn't support.
- 17 **Luis:** Keep both invoice numbers and the receipt amount together in the request, please. That will help our team identify the right payment.
- 18 **Ava:** The ⁹ _____ summary will show 410 at \$600, 411 at \$400, and Pine's identified \$600 receipt awaiting application.
- 19 **Luis:** I'll ask for the intended reference. Then you'll have something firmer than an amount that happens to match.
- 20 **Ava:** Exactly. The missing ¹⁰ _____ will support the next settlement review. For now, the receipt is acknowledged and both invoice applications remain unresolved.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. cash receipt | 2. open invoice | 3. matching amount | 4. remittance advice | 5. net difference | 6. invoice-level balance | 7. allocation query | 8. overdue | 9. customer account | 10. allocation instruction

Acknowledge the receipt and query its application

F Say it

Complete the customer-account readback. Keep the net calculation separate from invoice settlement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

allocation / 600 / 1000 / 400

Clerk: "The identified receipt is ¹ _____ dollars."

Customer: "The two invoices total ² _____ dollars."

Clerk: "The net difference across these items is ³ _____ dollars."

Customer: "The receipt still needs ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. 600 | 2. 1000 | 3. 400 | 4. allocation

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the customer-receipt dialogue.
2. Read the receipt acknowledgment and allocation request aloud. Keep \$1,000 invoiced, \$600 received, and \$400 net difference separate from individual invoice settlement.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the readback without asking for the same payment again.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A July posting helps explain June

A Read the situation

03

Describe a plausible timing difference with the correct direction and dates while keeping the broader reconciliation incomplete.

A fictional bank reconciliation runs through June 30. The bank balance is \$300 lower than the cash ledger. A \$300 deposit entered in the ledger on June 30 appears in the bank's July 1 activity. Other reconciliation checks are not complete. Bookkeeper Nia explains the timing evidence to colleague Omar without claiming that every difference has been cleared or that an adjusting entry is automatically needed.

PEOPLE / Omar: Finance colleague | Nia: Bookkeeper

EXPLAIN A PLAUSIBLE CAUSE WITHOUT DECLARING THE REVIEW FINISHED

A matching amount and sensible timing can support an explanation while other checks remain open. Name the cutoff, the direction of the difference, and both posting dates. A careful summary can be useful without overstating the completeness of the reconciliation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which balance is lower at June 30?

- A The bank balance by \$300
- C Both are equal

- B The cash ledger by \$300
- D The supplier balance by \$600

2. When does the deposit appear in bank activity?

- A An unknown year-end date
- C June 1

- B July 1
- D June 30 in both records

3. What is the status of the broader reconciliation?

- A All differences disproved
- C Other checks remain incomplete

- B An adjusting entry already posted
- D Fully completed and approved

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

bank reconciliation

Comparison explaining differences between bank and accounting records.

IN USE prepare a bank reconciliation

cash ledger

Accounting record containing the relevant cash transactions.

IN USE compare the cash ledger

bank balance

Amount reported in the relevant bank record.

IN USE identify the bank balance

ledger balance

Amount shown in the corresponding accounting record.

IN USE distinguish the ledger balance

reconciliation cutoff

Date through which the comparison is being prepared.

IN USE state the reconciliation cutoff

deposit

Money placed into the relevant bank account.

IN USE trace the deposit

deposit in transit

Deposit recorded by the business but not yet recorded by the bank at the comparison date.

IN USE identify a deposit in transit

timing difference

Mismatch caused by the same item appearing at different times.

IN USE explain a timing difference

bank activity

Transactions appearing in the bank's record.

IN USE check subsequent bank activity

posting date

Date on which an entry is recorded in a system.

IN USE compare posting dates

subsequent activity

Transactions recorded after the period being reviewed.

IN USE inspect subsequent activity

reconciling item

Item explaining part of a difference between records.

IN USE document a reconciling item

Precision check

At the June 30 cutoff, the bank is \$300 lower than the ledger. A \$300 deposit recorded in the ledger on June 30 appears at the bank on July 1. That sequence is consistent with a timing difference in the stated direction.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

outstanding check

Issued check not yet reflected as cleared in the relevant bank record.

IN USE distinguish an outstanding check

bank charge

Fee recorded by the bank for a relevant service.

IN USE identify a bank charge

interest credit

Amount added by the bank for earned interest.

IN USE distinguish an interest credit

recording error

Incorrect entry of a transaction or amount.

IN USE investigate a recording error

adjusted balance

Balance after the relevant reconciliation adjustments are considered.

IN USE verify the adjusted balance

unreconciled difference

Portion of a discrepancy not yet fully resolved.

IN USE report an unreconciled difference

reconciliation evidence

Records supporting the comparison and explanation.

IN USE retain reconciliation evidence

direction of difference

Which figure is higher or lower and by how much.

IN USE state the direction of difference

completion claim

Statement that the whole review has been finished.

IN USE qualify a completion claim

review status

Current stage of the checking process.

IN USE preserve review status

ledger adjustment

Change posted to the accounting record through the relevant process.

IN USE distinguish a ledger adjustment

reconciliation sign-off

Confirmation of the completed review by the relevant person.

IN USE obtain reconciliation sign-off

Precision check

The deposit is already recorded in the ledger, so do not propose recording it again merely to explain the timing. Other reconciliation checks are unfinished. The matching amount supports the explanation but does not establish a complete reconciliation or approved adjustment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

NAME THE CUTOFF

"This reconciliation is through June 30."

IDENTIFY THE LEDGER ENTRY

"The deposit was recorded in the ledger on June 30."

EXPLAIN THE TIMING

"The same deposit appears on opposite sides of the cutoff."

USE THE TECHNICAL TERM

"It is a deposit-in-transit item at the comparison date."

STATE THE DIRECTION

"The bank balance is \$300 lower than the cash ledger."

IDENTIFY THE BANK DATE

"It appears in the bank activity on July 1."

QUALIFY THE EXPLANATION

"That is consistent with a timing difference."

AVOID REVERSING THE DIFFERENCE

"The bank is lower, not higher, at June 30."

Through June 30

Defines the comparison cutoff rather than a later bank date.

Lower than

Preserves the direction of the stated difference.

On July 1

Gives the subsequent bank appearance of the deposit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

KEEP THE RECEIPT DISTINCT

"The ledger already contains the deposit."

AVOID DUPLICATE RECORDING

"We should not record the same deposit again merely for timing."

PRESERVE THE OPEN CHECKS

"Other reconciliation checks are not complete."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"This explains a plausible item, not the whole review."

REQUEST THE EVIDENCE

"Keep both dated records with the reconciliation."

SEPARATE CORRECTION AND TIMING

"A timing difference is not automatically a recording error."

AVOID PREMATURE SIGN-OFF

"I cannot call the reconciliation complete yet."

CLOSE WITH A QUALIFIED SUMMARY

"The deposit supports the timing explanation; the remaining checks are still open."

Consistent with

Signals supported interpretation without claiming every check is complete.

Already contains

Explains why blindly adding the same deposit again would be misleading.

Not complete yet

Keeps the broader review state explicit.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation has the correct direction?

- A** The bank includes an extra \$300 that the ledger lacks
- B** Both records have identical cutoff activity
- C** The deposit proves a \$600 loss
- D** The June 30 ledger includes \$300 that appears at the bank July 1

2. Why should the deposit not simply be entered again?

- A** It is already recorded in the cash ledger
- B** The bank never recorded it
- C** Every timing difference requires duplicate posting
- D** The ledger has no cash account

3. Which completion statement is accurate?

- A** Every difference is necessarily the same deposit
- B** The timing item is supported, but other checks remain open
- C** The whole reconciliation is signed off
- D** No further checks are possible

4. Which evidence supports this cutoff explanation?

- A** A second \$300 ledger deposit entered to match the bank
- B** An undated note saying the totals look equal
- C** The June 30 ledger deposit linked to its July 1 bank appearance
- D** The July 1 bank balance without the June cutoff record

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A July posting helps explain June

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ledger adjustment / timing difference / direction of difference / Reconciliation sign-off / reconciling item / reconciliation cutoff / review status / bank activity / deposit in transit / cash ledger

- 01 **Omar:** The June summary has the bank three hundred below the ledger. Have you found an explanation, or are we still looking for the missing amount?
- 02 **Nia:** There's evidence of a ¹ _____. A \$300 deposit is in the ledger on June 30 and appears in bank activity on July 1.
- 03 **Omar:** So at the June cutoff the ledger includes it, but the bank doesn't show it until the next day.
- 04 **Nia:** Right. Our ² _____ is June 30. The sequence fits the bank being lower by \$300, not higher.
- 05 **Omar:** Is deposit in transit the right wording? I don't want the manager to read missing deposit as money the bank has lost.
- 06 **Nia:** Yes, the dated records support a ³ _____ at that comparison date. Its appearance on July 1 supports the timing explanation.
- 07 **Omar:** It matches the entire difference. Can I mark the reconciliation complete now?
- 08 **Nia:** Not yet. The ⁴ _____ still includes unfinished checks. One matching amount doesn't show that we've reviewed every other transaction.
- 09 **Omar:** Then the update should say we've found supporting evidence, while leaving the rest of the review open.
- 10 **Nia:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ is supported by the two dated records. Keep that progress separate from a claim that all checks are finished.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Omar:** Someone suggested adding another three hundred to the ledger so the records agree. Would that be the adjustment?
- 12 **Nia:** No. The ⁶ _____ already includes this deposit. Recording it again merely because the bank shows it later would duplicate the same receipt.
- 13 **Omar:** So we first distinguish a timing item from an unrecorded transaction. Not every difference calls for another entry.
- 14 **Nia:** Correct. These facts don't establish a ⁷ _____. We are explaining the existing deposit, not authorizing a duplicate posting.
- 15 **Omar:** What should stay with the reconciliation so another reviewer can verify the explanation?
- 16 **Nia:** Keep the June 30 ledger entry and July 1 ⁸ _____ together, with the amount and their connection visible.
- 17 **Omar:** I'll write bank lower by \$300 at June 30, matching deposit in the bank the next day, other checks unfinished.
- 18 **Nia:** That preserves the ⁹ _____ and the review limit. It doesn't hide unfinished work behind the word balanced.
- 19 **Omar:** And I won't say approved. The evidence is progress, but the remaining checks still have to be completed.
- 20 **Nia:** Agreed. ¹⁰ _____ is outstanding. Keep the supported timing explanation in the working file for the rest of the review.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. timing difference | 2. reconciliation cutoff | 3. deposit in transit | 4. review status | 5. reconciling item | 6. cash ledger | 7. ledger adjustment | 8. bank activity | 9. direction of difference | 10. Reconciliation sign-off

Explain the cutoff difference precisely

F Say it

03

Complete the reconciliation summary using the supplied direction, amount, dates, and review status.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

incomplete / 1 / lower / 30

Bookkeeper: "At June 30, the bank is \$300 ¹ _____ than the ledger."

Colleague: "The deposit is recorded in the ledger on June ² _____."

Bookkeeper: "It appears at the bank on July ³ _____."

Colleague: "Other reconciliation checks remain ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. lower | 2. 30 | 3. 1 | 4. incomplete

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the reconciliation dialogue.
2. Read the cutoff explanation aloud: June 30 ledger, July 1 bank, bank \$300 lower at June 30. Then read why a second ledger deposit is not justified.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Retain the unfinished review status in the corrected summary.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A missing clock-out is not a known finish time

04

A Read the situation

Request evidence for a time-record exception while distinguishing the roster, employee recollection, and confirmed actual work time.

Employee Eli's Tuesday timecard has no clock-out entry. The roster shows a 17:00 finish, while Eli recalls finishing at 17:30. Supervisor Hana can review a work log before the internal approval cutoff at 14:00 today. Payroll assistant Dev must request that review and preserve both sources without choosing a finish time. Actual finish time is unconfirmed. The internal cutoff does not authorize an invented entry or determine Eli's pay rights.

PEOPLE / Dev: Payroll assistant | Hana: Supervisor

KEEP THE EVIDENCE REQUEST SEPARATE FROM A JUDGMENT ABOUT THE EMPLOYEE

A missing entry is a record problem, not proof of dishonesty or proof that no work occurred. Attribute the roster and recollection clearly. Ask the appropriate reviewer to examine the available log and report the verified status without forcing the record to fit a deadline.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing from Tuesday's timecard?

- A A clock-out entry
- C A confirmed wage rate

- B Eli's entire employment record
- D The supplied roster finish

2. How do the two time sources differ?

- A Roster says 17:00; Eli recalls 17:30
- C Roster says 14:00; Eli recalls noon

- B Both confirm 17:00 actual finish
- D Both prove thirty minutes of unauthorized absence

3. What can Hana review before 14:00?

- A The work log
- C A fabricated clock-out

- B A final approved payroll already released
- D An unrelated supplier invoice

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

timecard

Record of employee work-time entries.

IN USE check the timecard

clock-out

Entry recording the end of a work period.

IN USE query a missing clock-out

clock-in

Entry recording the start of a work period.

IN USE verify the clock-in

roster

Planned schedule of assigned work.

IN USE distinguish the roster

scheduled finish

End time shown in the planned schedule.

IN USE identify the scheduled finish

actual finish

Time work actually ended, established through relevant evidence.

IN USE verify the actual finish

employee recollection

Employee's remembered account of events or timing.

IN USE record the employee recollection

work log

Record of work activity relevant to the review.

IN USE review the work log

time exception

Missing or inconsistent timekeeping information requiring review.

IN USE raise a time exception

supervisor review

Check carried out by the relevant supervising person.

IN USE request supervisor review

internal cutoff

Organization's stated processing or approval deadline.

IN USE meet the internal cutoff

approval status

Current state of the required permission or verification.

IN USE report approval status

Precision check

The roster gives 17:00, Eli recalls 17:30, and the actual finish remains unconfirmed. Do not convert the scheduled time into verified work time or treat a missing clock-out as proof of no work.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

time correction

Authorized amendment to a time record based on the relevant evidence.

IN USE document a time correction

source attribution

Identification of where a statement or figure came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

unverified entry

Record value that has not yet been established.

IN USE avoid an unverified entry

exception queue

List of time or payroll issues awaiting review.

IN USE maintain the exception queue

pay period

Defined interval covered by the relevant payroll.

IN USE identify the pay period

timesheet approval

Confirmation of a time record under the actual process.

IN USE distinguish timesheet approval

audit trail

Record showing the history and basis of changes.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

scheduled hours

Work time indicated by the roster.

IN USE separate scheduled hours

reported hours

Work time described by a person or source.

IN USE qualify reported hours

verified hours

Work time established through the relevant review.

IN USE distinguish verified hours

review outcome

Finding or unresolved status produced by a check.

IN USE record the review outcome

payroll handoff

Transfer of relevant payroll information to the next responsible person.

IN USE complete the payroll handoff

Precision check

Hana can review the work log before the internal 14:00 cutoff. That deadline is for the fictional review process; it is not a rule about pay entitlement. Any correction needs its evidence, reviewer, and actual approval status preserved.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE EXCEPTION

"Tuesday's timecard is missing a clock-out."

ATTRIBUTE THE RECOLLECTION

"Eli recalls finishing at 17:30."

REQUEST THE EVIDENCE REVIEW

"Could you review the work log?"

AVOID DEFAULTING TO THE ROSTER

"I will not treat the scheduled finish as verified actual time."

NAME THE PLANNED TIME

"The roster shows a 17:00 finish."

STATE THE UNRESOLVED FACT

"The actual finish time is not confirmed."

NAME THE INTERNAL DEADLINE

"The approval cutoff is 14:00 today."

AVOID DEFAULTING TO MEMORY

"The recollection needs to remain attributed."

Shows versus recalls

Distinguishes a planned schedule from an employee's remembered account.

Actual

Refers to what happened, not simply what was scheduled.

Before 14:00

Defines the internal review window, not a rule about wages.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REJECT A FALSE INFERENCE

"A missing entry does not prove no work occurred."

PRESERVE BOTH SOURCES

"Please keep the roster and Eli's account visible."

KEEP APPROVAL EXPLICIT

"Has the time correction actually been approved?"

AVOID AN INVENTED ENTRY

"I will not fill the gap just to clear the queue."

KEEP THE REQUEST NEUTRAL

"I am asking for verification, not assigning blame."

ASK FOR THE OUTCOME

"Report what the log supports and what remains unresolved."

PRESERVE THE CHANGE HISTORY

"The correction needs its supporting trail."

CLOSE WITH THE HANDOFF

"The work-log review is pending; actual finish remains unconfirmed."

Supports

Connects a conclusion to evidence.

Remain attributed

Keeps a reported claim attached to its source.

Just to clear

Identifies administrative pressure that does not establish a fact.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which exception note is accurate?

- A** Missing Tuesday clock-out; roster 17:00; Eli recalls 17:30; actual finish unconfirmed
- B** Eli definitely finished at 17:00
- C** Eli definitely finished at 17:30
- D** Eli did no work because the entry is missing

2. What should Hana be asked to do?

- A** Treat the internal cutoff as a pay-rights decision
- B** Review the work log and report the supported finding
- C** Select the earlier time automatically
- D** Enter the later time without review

3. Which statement about 14:00 is correct?

- A** It establishes the actual Tuesday finish
- B** It proves the employee's pay entitlement
- C** It is the scheduled Tuesday clock-out
- D** It is the fictional internal approval cutoff

4. What should accompany an authorized correction?

- A** An erased history of the earlier gap
- B** A guessed finish time
- C** An unrelated supplier approval
- D** The evidence and review trail

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

A missing clock-out is not a known finish time

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

scheduled finish / source attribution / time exception / actual finish / internal cutoff / work log / approval status / review outcome / audit trail / payroll handoff

- 01 **Dev:** Could you review Eli's missing Tuesday clock-out? The roster and recollection don't agree, and we need the evidence checked before today's internal cutoff.
- 02 **Hana:** Please give me the ¹ _____ for each time. I want to know what the roster says and what Eli reported before drawing any conclusion about the actual finish.
- 03 **Dev:** The roster says 17:00. Eli recalls 17:30, but the timecard has no end entry.
- 04 **Hana:** Then the ² _____ is still unconfirmed. We should not select seventeen hundred simply because it was scheduled, or seventeen thirty simply because it was recalled.
- 05 **Dev:** There's a work log available. Can you review it before 14:00 today?
- 06 **Hana:** Yes. I will review the ³ _____ and report what it supports. Please keep the missing clock-out and both reported times visible while that review is pending.
- 07 **Dev:** I'm being asked to clear the queue. Entering the roster time now and checking later would make an assumption look verified.
- 08 **Hana:** Do not treat a ⁴ _____ as verified actual time merely to clear the queue. The deadline does not create evidence that the missing entry currently lacks.
- 09 **Dev:** Please keep the request neutral. A missed clock-out doesn't mean Eli did no work.
- 10 **Hana:** Call it a ⁵ _____ requiring review. We are checking a record gap; we have not established dishonesty, absence, or a confirmed finish time.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Dev:** Once you begin checking, can I say 17:30 is approved, or do I need the actual result?
- 12 **Hana:** Wait for the ⁶ _____. Starting a check is not approval of a particular time. If the evidence remains inconclusive, that unresolved status must be reported accurately.
- 13 **Dev:** And the 14:00 cutoff is today's internal review deadline, not a rule deciding Eli's entitlement to pay.
- 14 **Hana:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ defines this processing window. It does not establish the actual hours worked or replace the applicable payroll and employment requirements.
- 15 **Dev:** When there's an authorized correction, the next colleague will need to see why the entry changed.
- 16 **Hana:** Preserve the ⁸ _____. The supporting information and approval status should remain traceable through the actual workplace process, not be replaced by an unexplained number.
- 17 **Dev:** I'll hand over Tuesday clock-out missing, roster 17:00, Eli recalls 17:30, log review pending before 14:00.
- 18 **Hana:** That is an accurate ⁹ _____. Add that actual finish remains unconfirmed, so the next person does not mistake the two candidate times for a completed decision.
- 19 **Dev:** I'll keep the exception visible and the actual finish unconfirmed until the review supplies a supported result.
- 20 **Hana:** Thank you. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ explicit. I will review the available log and report the supported result or remaining uncertainty before the stated internal cutoff.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. source attribution | 2. actual finish | 3. work log | 4. scheduled finish | 5. time exception | 6. review outcome | 7. internal cutoff | 8. audit trail | 9. payroll handoff | 10. approval status

Request the time review without selecting a result

F Say it

Complete the time-exception summary using the distinct sources and the actual review deadline.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

17:00 / 17:30 / 14:00 / clock-out

Assistant: "The missing entry is Tuesday's ¹ _____."

Supervisor: "The roster gives ² _____."

Assistant: "Eli recalls ³ _____."

Supervisor: "The internal review cutoff is ⁴ _____ today."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. clock-out | 2. 17:00 | 3. 17:30 | 4. 14:00

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the time-exception dialogue.
2. Read the attributed times aloud: roster 17:00, Eli recalls 17:30, actual finish unconfirmed. Keep today's 14:00 internal review deadline separate.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the evidence request without selecting an unsupported finish time.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Same gross pay, fifty dollars less net

A Read the situation

Explain the arithmetic of two payroll previews while separating a visible deduction from its unverified supporting authority.

05

Preview A shows Morgan's gross pay of \$1,200, deductions of \$200, and net pay of \$1,000. Preview B shows the same \$1,200 gross pay, deductions of \$250, and net pay of \$950. A new \$50 deduction line is present, but its supporting record is pending. Payroll assistant Leila must explain the numerical change to Morgan without calling it a salary cut, guessing the deduction's purpose, or declaring it authorized.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Employee | Leila: Payroll assistant

LEAD WITH THE EMPLOYEE'S ACTUAL QUESTION

A lower net figure can look like lower gross pay. Explain the unchanged gross amount and the increased deduction total plainly. Then address the missing support as a separate unresolved question; correct arithmetic does not prove a deduction is valid or approved.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What stays the same in both previews?

A Every line of the calculation

C Deductions of \$200

B Gross pay of \$1,200

D Net pay of \$1,000

2. Why is B's net pay \$50 lower arithmetically?

A Deductions increase from \$200 to \$250

C Net pay is unrelated to deductions

B Gross pay falls by \$50

D A confirmed tax rule changes the salary

3. What remains pending?

A Support for the new \$50 deduction

C The arithmetic difference

B The amount of gross pay

D An already completed refund

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

payroll preview

Preliminary display of a payroll calculation before final processing.

IN USE compare payroll previews

gross pay

Pay amount before the relevant deductions.

IN USE state gross pay

deduction

Amount subtracted from pay in the stated calculation.

IN USE identify a deduction

net pay

Amount remaining after the stated deductions.

IN USE explain net pay

deduction total

Combined amount of the listed deductions.

IN USE compare deduction totals

deduction line

Individual entry identifying an amount subtracted.

IN USE query a new deduction line

supporting record

Evidence explaining or authorizing the relevant entry.

IN USE request the supporting record

pay statement

Document showing the relevant earnings and deductions.

IN USE read the pay statement

earnings line

Entry showing a component of pay before deductions.

IN USE distinguish an earnings line

pay component

Separately identifiable part of remuneration or its calculation.

IN USE identify the pay component

payroll register

Record summarizing payroll details for the relevant run.

IN USE check the payroll register

pay run

Particular cycle of payroll calculation and processing.

IN USE identify the pay run

Precision check

Both previews show \$1,200 gross. A subtracts \$200 to reach \$1,000 net; B subtracts \$250 to reach \$950 net. The \$50 net decrease corresponds to the \$50 deduction increase, not a stated reduction in gross pay.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

preview comparison

Review of differences between preliminary calculations.

IN USE prepare a preview comparison

gross-to-net

Relationship between gross pay, deductions, and the resulting net amount.

IN USE explain gross-to-net movement

regular rate of pay

Overtime calculation rate including required pay components, not just base pay.

IN USE verify the regular rate

nondiscretionary bonus

Bonus that does not meet the applicable discretionary-bonus exclusion criteria.

IN USE review a nondiscretionary bonus

deduction authority

Valid basis or approval required for a deduction under applicable rules.

IN USE verify deduction authority

payroll query

Request for clarification about a pay record or calculation.

IN USE raise a payroll query

withholding

Amount retained from pay under the relevant applicable basis.

IN USE distinguish withholding from gross pay

voluntary deduction

Deduction based on an applicable employee election or agreement.

IN USE verify a voluntary deduction

statutory deduction

Deduction arising under relevant legal requirements.

IN USE distinguish a statutory deduction

correction status

Whether a change has been requested, approved, or processed.

IN USE report correction status

final payroll

Completed payroll at the relevant processing stage.

IN USE distinguish a preview from final payroll

variance explanation

Account of how and why compared figures differ.

IN USE give a variance explanation

Precision check

A visible deduction line is not proof of its authority. The supporting record is pending, and the purpose has not been supplied. Do not label it tax, insurance, or a voluntary choice, and do not promise a refund or final pay outcome.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"You are asking why preview B shows less net pay."

EXPLAIN PREVIEW A

"A shows \$200 in deductions and \$1,000 net."

STATE THE MOVEMENT

"Deductions rise by \$50 and net pay falls by \$50."

SEPARATE ARITHMETIC AND AUTHORITY

"The calculation explains the difference, not whether the line is authorized."

START WITH THE UNCHANGED FIGURE

"Gross pay remains \$1,200 in both previews."

EXPLAIN PREVIEW B

"B shows \$250 in deductions and \$950 net."

IDENTIFY THE NEW LINE

"Preview B includes a new \$50 deduction."

NAME THE EVIDENCE GAP

"The supporting record is still pending."

Remains

Marks the gross-pay amount as unchanged.

Rise by and fall by

Describe opposite movements of the same fifty-dollar magnitude.

Includes

Establishes that a line appears, not that it is authorized.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN INVENTED PURPOSE

"I cannot identify this as tax or insurance from the information supplied."

REQUEST THE SUPPORT

"Please provide the record supporting the new deduction."

AVOID A REFUND PROMISE

"No correction or refund has been established yet."

SUMMARIZE PRECISELY

"Same gross pay; higher deductions; lower net pay; support pending."

AVOID A SALARY-CUT CLAIM

"The previews do not show a reduction in gross pay."

KEEP THE STATUS PROVISIONAL

"We are discussing a preview, not a confirmed final payment."

KEEP PERSONAL DETAILS LIMITED

"We should use the appropriate private payroll channel."

CLOSE WITH THE UNRESOLVED QUESTION

"The new line needs its basis verified before its status can be explained fully."

Not whether

Separates a mathematical explanation from an approval question.

Still pending

Preserves the unresolved supporting-record status.

Preview, not final

Limits what can be claimed about a future payment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which calculation matches preview B?

- A** \$950 plus \$50 equals \$1,200
- B** \$1,200 minus \$250 equals \$950
- C** \$1,200 minus \$200 equals \$950
- D** \$1,150 minus \$250 equals \$1,000

2. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** The preview proves a refund has been approved
- B** Net falls because deductions rise, while gross remains unchanged
- C** Gross salary was definitely reduced
- D** The new deduction is definitely insurance

3. Which reply addresses Morgan's unresolved question?

- A** I will verify the new \$50 line's purpose and authority from its supporting record
- B** I have checked that \$1,200 minus \$250 is \$950, so the line needs no review
- C** I will describe the \$50 as insurance because that is a common deduction
- D** I will confirm a \$50 refund before the line is reviewed

4. Which statement overclaims?

- A** The line is fifty dollars
- B** The supporting record is pending
- C** Both gross figures are twelve hundred
- D** The new line is authorized because it appears in the preview

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Same gross pay, fifty dollars less net

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

payroll query / correction status / payroll preview / deduction line / deduction total / final payroll / gross-to-net / gross pay / variance explanation / supporting record

- 01 **Morgan:** My preview has dropped from a thousand to nine hundred fifty. Has somebody reduced my salary?
- 02 **Leila:** The ¹ _____ shown hasn't changed: it's \$1,200 in both previews. Let's compare the deductions next.
- 03 **Morgan:** Could you take me through A and B in the same order? I want to see where the fifty appears.
- 04 **Leila:** A's ² _____ is \$200, leaving \$1,000 net. B subtracts \$250 from the same gross, leaving \$950.
- 05 **Morgan:** So the extra fifty deducted explains the fifty less left over. It isn't a fifty-dollar change to the twelve hundred.
- 06 **Leila:** That's the ³ _____ movement. The subtraction agrees, but we still need to check the basis of the new line.
- 07 **Morgan:** What is it for? I can't tell whether it's tax, insurance, or something I chose.
- 08 **Leila:** The new \$50 ⁴ _____ is visible, but its supporting record is pending. I can't identify its purpose from the information here.
- 09 **Morgan:** I assumed anything appearing on a preview had already been checked and approved. Is that not established?
- 10 **Leila:** Not by this ⁵ _____ alone. It shows a calculation, not proof of the authority behind every line.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Morgan:** Please ask about that specific fifty. I'm not disputing twelve hundred minus two hundred fifty; I need to know why the new charge is there.
- 12 **Leila:** Understood. The ⁶ _____ will focus on the new line's basis, not simply repeat the subtraction you've already checked.
- 13 **Morgan:** Could the reviewer see that distinction? Otherwise I may get the same numerical explanation without an answer to my concern.
- 14 **Leila:** I'll request the ⁷ _____ and clarification of the line's purpose and authority. Those are the unresolved questions.
- 15 **Morgan:** Should I treat nine hundred fifty as my final payment, or is that still not confirmed?
- 16 **Leila:** We aren't confirming ⁸ _____ here. With these preliminary records and missing support, I can't promise that amount, a correction, or a refund.
- 17 **Morgan:** Please handle my records through the appropriate payroll contact. I don't want this sent to people who aren't reviewing it.
- 18 **Leila:** Of course. I'll report the ⁹ _____ through the appropriate private process. Currently support is pending, with no completed change established.
- 19 **Morgan:** Then the summary is same gross, fifty more deducted, fifty less net, and the reason for that new deduction still needs checking.
- 20 **Leila:** Yes. That's the ¹⁰ _____ the records support. I'll carry the specific evidence question forward without treating the preview as final approval.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. gross pay | 2. deduction total | 3. gross-to-net | 4. deduction line | 5. payroll preview | 6. payroll query | 7. supporting record | 8. final payroll | 9. correction status | 10. variance explanation

Explain the preview without endorsing the deduction

F Say it

Complete the gross-to-net readback. Preserve the unchanged gross figure and the pending support.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

1200 / pending / 950 / 250

Assistant: "Gross pay remains ¹ _____ dollars."

Employee: "Preview B shows ² _____ dollars in deductions."

Assistant: "That leaves ³ _____ dollars net in B."

Employee: "The supporting record is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. 1200 | 2. 250 | 3. 950 | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the payroll-preview dialogue.
2. Read A and B in the same order: gross, deductions, net. Then read Morgan's question about the new \$50 line and Leila's evidence request.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Keep correct subtraction separate from authorization and final payment.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Seven approved items, no released batch

A Read the situation

Distinguish invoice approval, proposed batch membership, payment release, and an excluded exception in a concise status handoff.

06

A fictional payment set contains eight invoices. Seven have recorded approval. Invoice V22 awaits a receiving document and is excluded from the proposed seven-item batch. The batch itself has not been released, and the approver returns at 15:00. Payment preparer Ben briefs colleague Imani, who must not tell suppliers that all eight invoices are approved or that any payment has already been sent. Return time is not a guaranteed release time.

PEOPLE / Imani: Finance colleague | Ben: Payment preparer

USE SEPARATE VERBS FOR SEPARATE CONTROL STAGES

Approved, included, released, and paid are not interchangeable. A brief update should identify the approved items, the proposed batch, and any excluded exception. Naming the approver's return helps plan follow-up, but it does not promise the outcome of that review.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many invoices have recorded approval?

A One

B None

C Seven

D Eight

2. Why is V22 excluded from the proposal?

A It has already been paid twice

B The supplier has canceled it

C Its amount is confirmed as zero

D Its receiving document is missing

3. What does 15:00 establish?

A A guaranteed release time

B Confirmation all suppliers are paid

C Automatic inclusion of V22

D The approver's return time

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

payment batch

Group of payment items prepared for joint processing.

IN USE prepare a payment batch

batch proposal

Suggested set of items for the next payment process.

IN USE distinguish the batch proposal

invoice approval

Recorded permission for the specified invoice under the relevant process.

IN USE verify invoice approval

recorded approval

Permission evidenced in the available record.

IN USE confirm recorded approval

batch release

Authorized step sending the prepared batch into the relevant payment process.

IN USE distinguish batch release

payment execution

Carrying out the payment instruction at the relevant stage.

IN USE verify payment execution

payment confirmation

Evidence that the specified payment action occurred.

IN USE request payment confirmation

excluded item

Entry deliberately left out of the proposed set.

IN USE identify the excluded item

receiving evidence

Record supporting receipt of the relevant goods.

IN USE obtain receiving evidence

approval dependency

Missing condition required before the next approval stage.

IN USE state the approval dependency

approver

Person authorized to give the relevant permission.

IN USE contact the approver

return time

Time when a person is expected to be available again.

IN USE state the return time

Precision check

There are eight invoices in the original set, seven with recorded approval, and seven in the proposed batch. V22 is excluded pending its receiving document. Do not describe V22 as approved simply because the other seven are approved.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

authorization limit

Boundary of what a recorded approval permits.

IN USE preserve the authorization limit

batch membership

Items included in the specified group.

IN USE confirm batch membership

control stage

Distinct step in checking or authorizing a transaction.

IN USE identify the control stage

release status

Whether the relevant batch has actually been released.

IN USE report release status

payment status

Current stage of the payment process.

IN USE clarify payment status

exception item

Entry requiring separate attention before the process can proceed.

IN USE track the exception item

pending evidence

Supporting material not yet available.

IN USE identify pending evidence

supplier update

Communication to a vendor about the relevant account position.

IN USE qualify a supplier update

remittance notice

Message describing a payment or its intended invoice application.

IN USE verify a remittance notice

approval trail

Record of who approved what and at which stage.

IN USE retain the approval trail

batch count

Number of entries in a specified payment group.

IN USE reconcile the batch count

status readback

Restatement of the stages and unresolved conditions.

IN USE give a status readback

Precision check

The seven-item batch has not been released. The approver returns at 15:00, but that is not a promise of release or supplier receipt of funds. Keep invoice approval, proposed inclusion, release, and payment confirmation separate.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORIGINAL SET

"We began with eight invoices."

NAME THE EXCEPTION

"V22 is awaiting its receiving document."

CONFIRM THE PROPOSED COUNT

"The proposal contains seven items."

STATE RELEASE STATUS

"The batch has not been released."

STATE THE APPROVED COUNT

"Seven have recorded approval."

STATE THE EXCLUSION

"V22 is excluded from the proposed batch."

KEEP ITEM AND BATCH STAGES SEPARATE

"Invoice approval is not the same as batch release."

AVOID A PAYMENT CLAIM

"We have no confirmation that payment has been sent."

06

Have recorded approval

Limits the claim to permission evidenced for the specified items.

Excluded from

Defines batch membership without canceling the invoice.

Has not been released

States the actual batch stage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME THE AVAILABILITY

"The approver returns at 15:00."

LIMIT THE TIMING INFERENCE

"That return time does not guarantee release."

06

PRESERVE THE MISSING EVIDENCE

"V22 still needs receiving support."

CORRECT AN OVERBROAD UPDATE

"It would be inaccurate to say all eight are approved."

REQUEST A STAGE-SPECIFIC ANSWER

"Are you asking about approval, inclusion, or release?"

KEEP SUPPLIERS INFORMED ACCURATELY

"I can report the current stage without promising payment."

READ BACK THE WHOLE POSITION

"Seven approved, V22 excluded, seven proposed, none confirmed released."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT REVIEW

"We will seek the relevant review when the approver is available."

Returns at

Describes availability, not an approval outcome.

All eight

Identifies the overgeneralization that the exception makes inaccurate.

Are you asking about ...?

Clarifies which control stage the other person means.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which status line is accurate?

- A** V22 included without receiving evidence
- B** Seven invoices approved; V22 excluded; proposed batch unreleased
- C** All eight approved and paid
- D** Seven released because they were approved

2. What would overstate the meaning of 15:00?

- A** Review depends on the relevant process
- B** Release is not yet confirmed
- C** Payments are guaranteed to be sent at 15:00
- D** The approver returns at 15:00

3. Which count belongs to the proposed batch?

- A** Seven
- B** Eight
- C** Fifteen
- D** Twenty-two

4. What information is still needed for V22?

- A** The receiving document
- B** An invented payment receipt
- C** Proof the other seven were canceled
- D** A new supplier name

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Seven approved items, no released batch

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

control stage / receiving evidence / recorded approval / supplier update / batch membership / approval trail / excluded item / release status / return time / exception item

- 01 **Imani:** A supplier asked whether the run is approved. There were eight invoices originally; are all eight ready to go?
- 02 **Ben:** No. Seven have ¹ _____. Invoice V22 is still awaiting a receiving document, and it is excluded from the proposed batch.
- 03 **Imani:** Then the proposed batch has seven, not eight. V22 stays outside it.
- 04 **Ben:** Correct. The ² _____ has changed. Keep V22 visible as an exception, but do not count it among the seven proposed payment items.
- 05 **Imani:** Have those seven been released, or are we only talking about invoice approval?
- 06 **Ben:** The ³ _____ is not released. Approval of the seven invoices does not mean the batch itself has passed the release stage or that payment has been sent.
- 07 **Imani:** What receiving document is missing for V22? I need a reason, not just held.
- 08 **Ben:** It is awaiting ⁴ _____, specifically the receiving document. That requirement remains open; the invoice has not become approved because the other seven are.
- 09 **Imani:** The approver is back at three. Is that a release time I can give the supplier?
- 10 **Ben:** It is the ⁵ _____, fifteen hundred. It tells us when the approver returns, not what the review outcome will be or when any payment will reach a supplier.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Imani:** I'll keep 15:00 as the approver's return, with no promised release time.
- 12 **Ben:** Exactly. Preserve the ⁶ _____. A useful update names where the process stands instead of using approved as a shorthand for every later step.
- 13 **Imani:** Could you read back the status for the team, so we don't use approved to mean several different things?
- 14 **Ben:** Seven invoices have approval; V22 is an ⁷ _____ pending its receiving document. The seven-item proposal is not released. The approver returns at fifteen hundred, with no release time guaranteed.
- 15 **Imani:** Does excluded mean canceled? I don't want someone telling V22's supplier the invoice has been rejected permanently.
- 16 **Ben:** No. It remains an ⁸ _____ needing its supporting document. Its absence from this proposal is not a cancellation decision or a statement that the supplier has no valid invoice.
- 17 **Imani:** I'll retain seven approved, seven proposed, V22 excluded, and the batch unreleased.
- 18 **Ben:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ should show the actual permissions while the release status remains separate. Nobody should infer payment confirmation merely from the existence of item approvals.
- 19 **Imani:** The supplier update will name the stage we actually know, without saying the money has gone.
- 20 **Ben:** Good. A ¹⁰ _____ can be specific without overpromising. The next review and any later release must be confirmed through the actual process before we report them as complete.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. recorded approval | 2. batch membership | 3. release status | 4. receiving evidence | 5. return time | 6. control stage | 7. excluded item | 8. exception item | 9. approval trail | 10. supplier update

Read back approval, exclusion, and release

F Say it

Complete the payment-status handoff without turning approval into payment confirmation.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

released / seven / V22 / 15:00

Preparer: "The number of approved invoices is ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The excluded invoice is ² _____."

Preparer: "The batch has not been ³ _____."

Colleague: "The approver returns at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. seven | 2. V22 | 3. released | 4. 15:00

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the payment-batch dialogue.
2. Read the full status aloud: eight original invoices, seven approved, V22 excluded, seven proposed, batch unreleased, approver back at 15:00.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the supplier update without promising release or receipt of funds.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Nine checks done, one period question open

A Read the situation

Hand over an unresolved cutoff question with its amount, dates, review owner, and unapproved posting status intact.

The fictional June close has nine of ten checklist items complete. A \$240 maintenance invoice is dated July 2 but describes June service. The accountant must review its posting period; no adjusting entry has been approved. Alex takes over the open-item follow-up from Hana at noon. The handoff must distinguish document date from service period and follow-up responsibility from authority to choose or post an accounting entry.

PEOPLE / Hana: Outgoing bookkeeper | Alex: Incoming bookkeeper

07

TRANSFER RESPONSIBILITY WITHOUT PRETENDING THE DECISION TRANSFERRED TOO

A good handoff gives the next person the unresolved question and the evidence needed to pursue it. It does not turn a follow-up owner into an accounting approver. Keep the incomplete checklist item visible even when the other nine tasks are finished.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many checklist items are complete?

A None

C All ten

B Nine of ten

D One of ten

2. What dates differ on the maintenance item?

A No date or service period is supplied

C Invoice dated June 2; service described as July

B Invoice dated July 2; service described as June

D Both document and service are confirmed in August

3. What does Alex take over at noon?

A Follow-up on the open item

C A fully approved close

B Automatic authority to post an adjustment

D Responsibility to erase the exception

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

period close

Process of completing accounting work for a defined reporting interval.

IN USE hand over the period close

close checklist

List of required tasks for finishing the reporting period.

IN USE update the close checklist

open item

Matter still unresolved or incomplete.

IN USE retain the open item

invoice date

Date printed or assigned to the supplier document.

IN USE identify the invoice date

service period

Interval during which the invoiced service was provided.

IN USE distinguish the service period

posting period

Accounting period to which an entry is assigned.

IN USE request posting-period review

cutoff question

Issue about which period should contain a transaction or amount.

IN USE raise a cutoff question

maintenance expense

Cost associated with relevant maintenance work.

IN USE identify the maintenance expense

accountant review

Evaluation by the relevant accounting professional.

IN USE obtain accountant review

adjusting entry

Accounting entry addressing the relevant period-end recognition or measurement.

IN USE distinguish an adjusting entry

accrual

Recognition of an amount in the relevant period before the associated cash settlement.

IN USE discuss an accrual question

accrued expense

Expense recognized with a related obligation before payment.

IN USE identify an accrued-expense review

Precision check

The invoice amount is \$240, its date is July 2, and its description refers to June service. Those are distinct facts. The accountant must review the posting period; the assistant should not choose July solely from the invoice date.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

prepayment

Payment made before the related benefit or service is fully received.

IN USE distinguish a prepayment

supporting invoice

Supplier bill retained as evidence for the review.

IN USE attach the supporting invoice

posting approval

Permission for the specified accounting entry.

IN USE verify posting approval

unposted item

Record or proposed transaction not yet entered in the ledger.

IN USE identify an unposted item

journal entry

Record of a transaction using the relevant accounting accounts.

IN USE review the journal entry

general ledger

Main accounting record containing account balances and entries.

IN USE distinguish the general ledger

follow-up owner

Person responsible for pursuing the next response or action.

IN USE name the follow-up owner

handover time

Time responsibility passes to the next person.

IN USE confirm the handover time

close status

Current completion stage of the period-end process.

IN USE report close status

carrying amount

Amount at which an asset or liability is recorded after relevant recognized adjustments.

IN USE reconcile the carrying amount

recognition schedule

Record allocating an amount to accounting periods under the specified treatment.

IN USE review the recognition schedule

cutoff evidence

Dates and service information relevant to the period question.

IN USE retain cutoff evidence

Precision check

Nine of ten checklist items are complete, so the close is not fully finished. Alex takes follow-up ownership at noon, but no adjusting entry has been approved. Follow-up responsibility does not establish authority to decide or post the entry.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE CLOSE POSITION

"Nine of ten checklist items are complete."

GIVE THE AMOUNT

"The invoice is for \$240."

GIVE THE SERVICE PERIOD

"The description refers to June service."

NAME THE REVIEWER

"The accountant needs to review the posting period."

NAME THE OPEN ITEM

"The maintenance invoice still needs period review."

GIVE THE DOCUMENT DATE

"It is dated July 2."

IDENTIFY THE DISTINCTION

"The invoice date and service period are not the same fact."

PRESERVE APPROVAL STATUS

"No adjusting entry has been approved."

Dated versus describes

Distinguishes the document's date from the service period it reports.

Still needs

Marks the review as outstanding.

Merely from

Identifies an insufficient basis for a decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN AUTOMATIC PERIOD CHOICE

"I will not assign July merely from the invoice date."

SEPARATE ROLES

"Owning the follow-up does not mean approving the entry."

AVOID FALSE COMPLETION

"The close is not ten out of ten yet."

REQUEST A CLEAR RESULT

"Please record the reviewed period and actual approval status."

TRANSFER THE FOLLOW-UP

"Alex takes over the open-item follow-up at noon."

KEEP THE EVIDENCE TOGETHER

"Retain the invoice and its June-service description."

STATE THE DEPENDENCY

"This item remains open pending the accountant's review."

CLOSE WITH THE HANDOFF

"Nine complete, one open, Alex following up, no entry approved."

Takes over at noon

Specifies when follow-up responsibility changes.

Does not mean approving

Separates administrative ownership from accounting authority.

Nine complete, one open

Prevents a high completion count from becoming a claim of full closure.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff preserves the facts?

- A** July date automatically proves July posting
- B** June close fully complete
- C** Alex has approved an adjusting entry
- D** \$240 invoice dated July 2 for June service; accountant review pending

2. What does nine of ten complete mean?

- A** The final item can be ignored
- B** Nine invoices have been paid
- C** One checklist item remains open
- D** All accounting decisions are final

3. Which responsibility changes at noon?

- A** Alex takes over follow-up
- B** Alex automatically becomes the posting approver
- C** The supplier changes the invoice date
- D** The entry is automatically posted

4. Which statement is unsupported?

- A** The document is dated July 2
- B** The adjusting entry has already been approved
- C** The invoice is \$240
- D** The description refers to June

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

Nine checks done, one period question open

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

adjusting entry / follow-up owner / cutoff question / invoice date / handover time / close status / posting approval / open item / cutoff evidence / accountant review

- 01 **Hana:** Alex, you're taking over at noon. Nine June-close checks are complete; the maintenance invoice is the one still awaiting review.
- 02 **Alex:** Please give me the ¹ _____ first, then the invoice details and the decision we are waiting for. I do not want the one open item hidden behind the completed count.
- 03 **Hana:** It's \$240, dated July 2, but the description says June service.
- 04 **Alex:** Then we need to distinguish the ² _____ from the service period. The printed July date should not make us overlook the fact that the description relates to June.
- 05 **Hana:** The accountant needs to decide the posting period. I haven't treated the July date as an automatic answer.
- 06 **Alex:** I will retain that ³ _____ as unresolved. The amount, document date, and service description give the reviewer the facts without our substituting an assumed answer.
- 07 **Hana:** There isn't an approved adjusting entry either. Knowing the amount doesn't mean the entry is ready.
- 08 **Alex:** I will make the ⁴ _____ status explicit. Knowing the amount does not establish that the period treatment or any proposed entry has been approved.
- 09 **Hana:** At noon you're taking over the follow-up, not the accountant's authority to approve the treatment.
- 10 **Alex:** Understood. I become the ⁵ _____, not the accounting approver. I will pursue the response and preserve the decision with its actual reviewer and approval status.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Hana:** Please retain June service beside July 2. A note saying only July invoice would lose the issue.
- 12 **Alex:** I will retain the ⁶ _____ together: two hundred forty dollars, July second invoice date, June service. None of those details should disappear in the summary.
- 13 **Hana:** Leave one item open after the handoff. Changing its owner doesn't complete it.
- 14 **Alex:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ stays visible. A change of owner is not a completed review, and nine out of ten must not become ten out of ten just because the handoff is done.
- 15 **Hana:** When the accountant responds, distinguish a period decision, an entry approval, and a request for more evidence.
- 16 **Alex:** I will preserve those distinctions in the ⁸ _____ result. A request for more evidence is not approval, and a period discussion should not be silently expanded into permission to post.
- 17 **Hana:** For now, no adjustment is authorized by this handoff. We just need the actual question and support reviewed.
- 18 **Alex:** Agreed. An ⁹ _____ has not been approved, so the handoff should not describe one as ready or already recorded. I will keep that limit attached to the item.
- 19 **Hana:** Readback: nine complete, one open; \$240 July 2 invoice for June service; accountant review pending; you follow up from noon.
- 20 **Alex:** That is accurate. The ¹⁰ _____ changes who pursues the response, not the unresolved accounting status. I will take the follow-up with all those facts intact.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. close status | 2. invoice date | 3. cutoff question | 4. posting approval | 5. follow-up owner | 6. cutoff evidence | 7. open item | 8. accountant review | 9. adjusting entry | 10. handover time

Hand over the period question without closing it

F Say it

Complete the close handoff with the amount, service period, review owner, and open status preserved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

open / June / accountant / 240

Bookkeeper: "The maintenance invoice is for ¹ _____ dollars."

Colleague: "Its description refers to ² _____ service."

Bookkeeper: "The ³ _____ must review the posting period."

Colleague: "One checklist item remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. 240 | 2. June | 3. accountant | 4. open

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the period-close handoff.
2. Read \$240, July 2 invoice date, June service, accountant review pending, and Alex taking follow-up at noon. Then read the unapproved-entry status.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Keep nine complete and one open even after the handoff.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A duplicate entry, not a recovered payment

A Read the situation

Correct an overstatement by distinguishing a confirmed tracker duplication from unposted ledger changes and unproven cash movements.

In fictional tracker version 3, invoice J14 for \$180 appears twice because the same file was imported twice. The controller has confirmed one duplicate entry. No ledger correction has been posted. A previous message wrongly said the duplicate payment had been recovered, but no duplicate payment is established. Bookkeeper Rosa must correct the message with controller Ellis and preserve a traceable record of the verified issue and any later authorized change.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Bookkeeper | Ellis: Controller

08

CORRECT THE STRONGEST FALSE CLAIM, NOT JUST THE SMALLEST NUMBER

Changing a tracker count does not repair a message claiming that money was recovered. Name the earlier statement, withdraw it, and replace it with the verified finding. Preserve the distinction between a file import, a ledger posting, and a cash transaction.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has the controller confirmed?

- A A completed ledger correction
- C Two actual supplier payments

- B One duplicate tracker entry for J14
- D A recovered \$180 payment

2. What is the current ledger-correction status?

- A A refund automatically changed the ledger
- C No correction has been posted

- B The ledger was deleted
- D A correction is fully posted

3. Which earlier claim is wrong?

- A Tracker version 3 contains a duplicate
- C The duplicate payment had been recovered

- B The same file was imported twice
- D J14 is for \$180

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

tracker

Working record used to monitor items or statuses.

IN USE identify the tracker

tracker version

Number or label distinguishing a revision of the working record.

IN USE specify tracker version

duplicate entry

Repeated record of the same underlying item.

IN USE confirm a duplicate entry

duplicate import

Repeated loading of the same source file or data.

IN USE identify a duplicate import

source file

Original file from which data were loaded.

IN USE preserve the source file

import log

Record of data-loading events and their status.

IN USE consult the import log

controller

Person overseeing the relevant accounting controls and reporting.

IN USE obtain controller confirmation

verified finding

Conclusion supported by the stated review.

IN USE report the verified finding

ledger correction

Authorized change to the accounting record.

IN USE distinguish a ledger correction

posted correction

Change actually entered in the ledger through the relevant process.

IN USE verify a posted correction

duplicate payment

Actual payment made more than once for the same obligation.

IN USE distinguish a duplicate payment

payment recovery

Return or recovery of money previously paid.

IN USE verify payment recovery

Precision check

J14 is a \$180 invoice shown twice in tracker version 3 because the same file was imported twice. Two displayed entries would total \$360, with one extra \$180 entry. That tracker arithmetic does not establish two payments, a \$180 cash loss, or a recovery.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cash movement

Actual transfer of money into or out of an account.

IN USE confirm cash movement

status correction

Amendment of an inaccurate progress or outcome statement.

IN USE issue a status correction

retraction

Explicit withdrawal of a previous unsupported claim.

IN USE make a precise retraction

correction trail

Record linking the original issue, evidence, and authorized change.

IN USE preserve the correction trail

record retention

Keeping information under the applicable requirements and process.

IN USE follow record-retention procedures

change authorization

Permission for a specified amendment.

IN USE obtain change authorization

transaction reference

Identifier connecting records to the relevant business item.

IN USE retain the transaction reference

working total

Sum calculated from a working record rather than a verified final ledger.

IN USE qualify a working total

overstatement

Claim or figure that exceeds what the evidence supports.

IN USE correct an overstatement

cross-reference

Link between related records or messages.

IN USE include a cross-reference

correction owner

Person responsible for carrying out the approved amendment.

IN USE identify the correction owner

resolution evidence

Information demonstrating that the specific issue has been resolved.

IN USE request resolution evidence

08

Precision check

The controller confirmed one duplicate entry, but no ledger correction has been posted. Withdraw the earlier recovery claim explicitly. Preserve the original reference, verified finding, and later authorized correction trail; do not silently erase the history or invent a cash transaction.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE RECORD

"This concerns tracker version 3 and invoice J14."

STATE THE INVOICE AMOUNT

"J14 is for \$180."

DESCRIBE THE DUPLICATION

"The same file was imported twice."

NAME THE VERIFIED FINDING

"The controller confirmed one duplicate entry."

KEEP TRACKER AND LEDGER SEPARATE

"A tracker duplicate is not automatically a posted ledger duplicate."

STATE POSTING STATUS

"No ledger correction has been posted."

SEPARATE RECORD AND PAYMENT

"A repeated entry does not prove a repeated payment."

OWN THE EARLIER ERROR

"My previous message said the duplicate payment had been recovered."

Appears twice

Describes the working record without asserting two underlying transactions.

Confirmed one duplicate

Specifies the verified issue and count.

Not automatically

Blocks an unsupported inference between different systems or stages.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

RETRACT THE CLAIM

"That recovery statement was unsupported and is withdrawn."

AVOID INVENTED CASH MOVEMENT

"We have not confirmed any recovered funds."

REQUEST AUTHORIZATION

"Any amendment needs the appropriate approval."

REPORT ONLY THE ACTUAL STAGE

"The duplicate entry is confirmed; the ledger correction is not posted."

STATE THE EVIDENCE LIMIT

"No duplicate payment has been established."

PRESERVE THE TRAIL

"Keep the original record and correction history linked."

MAKE THE CORRECTION VISIBLE

"I will send an explicit correction to the earlier recipients."

CLOSE WITH A PRECISE STATUS

"One tracker duplicate, no established duplicate payment, no posted ledger correction."

08

Was unsupported and is withdrawn

Corrects the earlier claim explicitly.

No ... established

Limits the evidence without inventing a contrary event.

Keep ... linked

Preserves traceability between the issue and its correction.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which correction is accurate?

- A** We recovered a second \$180 payment
- B** The ledger is already corrected
- C** Two tracker rows prove two bank transfers
- D** One J14 tracker duplicate is confirmed; no duplicate payment or recovery is established

2. What does twice \$180 establish here?

- A** The duplicate tracker rows sum to \$360
- B** The supplier received \$360
- C** The bank refunded \$180
- D** A final ledger balance is \$360

3. Which action preserves the trail?

- A** Link the explicit correction to the original message and supporting records
- B** Erase every trace of the earlier claim
- C** Invent a refund receipt
- D** Mark the ledger correction posted without evidence

4. Which status remains uncompleted?

- A** Recognition that the file was imported twice
- B** Ledger correction posting
- C** Controller confirmation of the duplicate
- D** Identification of J14

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

A duplicate entry, not a recovered payment

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

payment recovery / import log / retraction / verified finding / Change authorization / duplicate entry / status correction / working total / correction trail / posted correction

08

- 01 **Rosa:** Ellis, my J14 update said a duplicate payment had been recovered. I need to withdraw that: the evidence only establishes a repeated tracker entry.
- 02 **Ellis:** That's right. The ¹ _____ is one duplicate J14 entry in tracker version 3 because the same file was imported twice.
- 03 **Rosa:** It's a \$180 invoice showing twice. I jumped from two rows to two payments, which wasn't justified.
- 04 **Ellis:** A ² _____ isn't proof of another payment. The correction needs to address that cash claim, not merely change the number of rows.
- 05 **Rosa:** The two rows sum to \$360 in the tracker. That doesn't show \$360 leaving the bank.
- 06 **Ellis:** Correct. It's a ³ _____ from the duplicated rows, not a verified bank or ledger balance. The extra \$180 displayed isn't an established cash loss.
- 07 **Rosa:** No ledger change has been posted either. I shouldn't say the accounts are fixed because you've identified the import problem.
- 08 **Ellis:** Exactly. A ⁴ _____ hasn't occurred. Confirming the issue, authorizing a change, and posting it are different stages.
- 09 **Rosa:** I'll send the same recipients a correction. How do I make sure the recovery claim doesn't remain the headline?
- 10 **Ellis:** Lead with a direct ⁵ _____: the statement that a duplicate payment was recovered was unsupported and is withdrawn. Then state the verified finding.



The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Rosa:** One duplicate J14 entry in version 3, same source file imported twice, and no duplicate payment established.
- 12 **Ellis:** Yes. Don't imply a ⁶ _____ either. Without evidence of a duplicate payment, we can't report recovered funds as an accomplished result.
- 13 **Rosa:** Should I remove the original message so nobody relies on it later?
- 14 **Ellis:** Preserve the ⁷ _____ through the actual records process. Link the explicit correction to the earlier message so readers can see what replaces the false claim.
- 15 **Rosa:** The source file and import information should remain available too, rather than disappearing during a tracker cleanup.
- 16 **Ellis:** Correct. The ⁸ _____ helps support how the duplication happened. Keep it connected to the review and any authorized amendment.
- 17 **Rosa:** Sending this correction doesn't give me permission to alter the ledger, so I'll keep those actions separate.
- 18 **Ellis:** Yes. ⁹ _____ must cover the specific amendment. A corrected message doesn't approve or post an accounting entry.
- 19 **Rosa:** My final wording will say one confirmed tracker duplicate, no established duplicate payment or recovery, and no ledger correction posted.
- 20 **Ellis:** That's the accurate ¹⁰ _____. Retain J14, version 3, and the supporting record, then report later resolution only when its evidence exists.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. verified finding | 2. duplicate entry | 3. working total | 4. posted correction | 5. retraction | 6. payment recovery | 7. correction trail | 8. import log | 9. Change authorization | 10. status correction

Retract the unsupported recovery claim

F Say it

Complete the corrected status message. Distinguish the tracker, invoice amount, and unproven payment claim.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

J14 / entry / posted / 180

08

Bookkeeper: "The invoice reference is ¹ _____."

Controller: "The invoice amount is ² _____ dollars."

Bookkeeper: "One duplicate tracker ³ _____ is confirmed."

Controller: "No ledger correction has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. J14 | 2. 180 | 3. entry | 4. posted

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the tracker-correction dialogue.
2. Read Rosa's retraction and the replacement finding aloud. Distinguish two \$180 tracker rows from actual payments or recovered funds.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the status with no posted ledger correction and the original references retained.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Paid once, expensed over time

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain a prepaid service schedule without confusing cash, cumulative expense, and the current adjustment.

Fictional annual support subscription: \$1,200 paid July 1 for service July 1 through June 30. The accountant specifies equal monthly recognition over twelve months, with no tax, impairment, cancellation, or other adjustment. July and August expenses of \$100 each are already posted. It is September 30; the September adjustment is not posted. Discuss the proposed schedule, not instructions to post or pay.

PEOPLE / Nia: Bookkeeper | Omar: Department manager

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

prepaid expense / carrying amount / current-period adjustment / noncash adjustment / cumulative expense / recognition schedule

- 01 **Omar:** The support supplier was paid twelve hundred dollars in July. Why does September's draft report show another hundred of expense? Are we paying them twice?
- 02 **Nia:** No. The original payment created a ¹ _____. The monthly recognition uses that already-paid amount; it doesn't send the supplier more money.
- 03 **Omar:** The service runs from July first to next June thirtieth. So the twelve hundred covers twelve months, not just the calendar months remaining this year.
- 04 **Nia:** Correct. Under the supplied ² _____, each month is one hundred dollars. We don't divide it by six just because the payment was made in July.
- 05 **Omar:** By September thirtieth, July, August, and September have passed. That makes three hundred dollars of expense for those three months together.
- 06 **Nia:** Yes, that's the proposed ³ _____ through September. But July and August's two hundred dollars are already recorded.
- 07 **Omar:** Then posting another three hundred for September would double-count those earlier two months. The new month adds only one hundred.
- 08 **Nia:** Exactly. The proposed ⁴ _____ is one hundred, not three hundred. A cumulative target and the incremental amount needed to reach it are different.
- 09 **Omar:** After that proposed adjustment, nine months remain: October through June. At a hundred a month, the unused service balance would be nine hundred.
- 10 **Nia:** That's the proposed ⁵ _____ of the prepaid asset. It's not nine hundred dollars sitting in the bank or automatically refundable by the supplier.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Omar:** What does the ledger show before September is posted? It should still have one thousand of prepaid service, since only two hundred has moved to expense.
- 12 **Nia:** Right. The September recognition is a ⁶ _____. It would reduce the prepaid balance from one thousand to nine hundred without changing cash.
- 13 **Omar:** So the bank payment stays twelve hundred in July. We shouldn't enter a new supplier invoice or another cash payment every month to explain the expense.
- 14 **Nia:** Correct. The schedule allocates the existing cost. A monthly expense line is not evidence of a monthly invoice or a second payment.
- 15 **Omar:** If the whole contract had been charged to July expense instead, this one-hundred-dollar proposal wouldn't describe the same starting ledger.
- 16 **Nia:** Exactly. The actual starting balance matters. This case explicitly says July and August were posted according to the prepaid schedule; we aren't correcting a different initial treatment.
- 17 **Omar:** Can I report September as complete now that the calculation agrees? The adjustment still hasn't gone through review and posting.
- 18 **Nia:** Keep it proposed. The arithmetic supports the schedule, but doesn't show that the required review or posting has occurred.
- 19 **Omar:** I'll explain twelve hundred paid once, two hundred already expensed, one hundred proposed for September, three hundred cumulative, and nine hundred remaining afterward.
- 20 **Nia:** That readback keeps cash, the ledger before adjustment, and the proposed closing balances distinct. Attach the service dates and schedule so the reviewer can follow the period basis.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. prepaid expense | 2. recognition schedule | 3. cumulative expense | 4. current-period adjustment | 5. carrying amount | 6. noncash adjustment

Separate cumulative and incremental

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional support subscription \$2,400 for twelve months starting April 1, recognized equally monthly. April and May expense is already posted at \$200 each. June 30 review is pending; June expense is not posted. No other adjustments or new payments apply.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

no / 1800 / 600 / 200

09

Manager: Expense through June should total ¹ _____ dollars.

Bookkeeper: Only ² _____ dollars remains for June recognition.

Manager: The proposed prepaid balance after June is ³ _____ dollars.

Bookkeeper: The June allocation requires ⁴ _____ additional cash payment.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 600 | 2. 200 | 3. 1800 | 4. no

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The bonus changes the regular rate

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain an overtime recalculation without confusing base rate, regular rate, total gross, and the remaining true-up.

Fictional US employee covered and nonexempt under the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA): one 44-hour workweek at \$20/hour, plus an \$88 production bonus earned entirely that week and confirmed includable in the regular rate. Use weekly overtime after 40 hours; no other compensation or rules alter this example. Original gross paid \$920: \$880 straight time plus \$40 overtime premium. Bonus and related true-up remain unpaid. This is gross-pay explanation, not tax or case-specific legal advice.

PEOPLE / Leila: Payroll assistant | Morgan: Payroll reviewer

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

gross earnings / nondiscretionary bonus / payroll reconciliation / half-time premium / true-up / regular rate

- 01 **Leila:** The original gross was nine hundred twenty dollars. I added the eighty-eight-dollar bonus and got one thousand eight. Is that the complete corrected amount?
- 02 **Morgan:** Not yet. The confirmed ¹ _____ belongs in this week's regular-rate calculation. Adding it to the old total alone misses the related overtime difference.
- 03 **Leila:** Straight-time earnings are forty-four hours at twenty dollars: eight hundred eighty. Adding the bonus gives nine hundred sixty-eight before the overtime premium.
- 04 **Morgan:** Right. The ² _____ is nine hundred sixty-eight divided by forty-four, or twenty-two dollars per hour. That's different from the twenty-dollar base rate.
- 05 **Leila:** I shouldn't divide by forty and exclude the overtime hours from the denominator. All forty-four worked hours belong in that calculation.
- 06 **Morgan:** Correct. And because straight time for all forty-four hours is included already, the extra ³ _____ is eleven dollars for each overtime hour, not another full thirty-three.
- 07 **Leila:** There are four overtime hours. Four times eleven gives forty-four dollars of overtime premium in the corrected calculation.
- 08 **Morgan:** Yes. The corrected ⁴ _____ are nine hundred sixty-eight plus forty-four, or one thousand twelve, before deductions.
- 09 **Leila:** The old payroll already paid forty dollars of overtime premium. So we don't owe a second full forty-four on top of that.
- 10 **Morgan:** Exactly. The remaining overtime ⁵ _____ is four dollars. With the unpaid eighty-eight-dollar bonus, the remaining gross payment is ninety-two.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Leila:** That reconciles: nine hundred twenty already paid plus ninety-two still due equals one thousand twelve. The bonus and the overtime increase are separate lines.
- 12 **Morgan:** Keep that ⁶ _____ in the review note. It shows the complete entitlement calculation and the smaller amount remaining, without double counting.
- 13 **Leila:** Would calling the payment discretionary on a spreadsheet remove it from this calculation? The approved facts say it was an includable production bonus.
- 14 **Morgan:** A label alone doesn't change its treatment. Here the classification and earning week are supplied; don't replace them with a more convenient label.
- 15 **Leila:** If the bonus covered several weeks instead, could I put the whole amount into whichever week we happen to process it?
- 16 **Morgan:** That isn't the fact pattern here. The actual earning period and applicable allocation rules would need review; this example puts it entirely in one specified workweek.
- 17 **Leila:** And ninety-two isn't a promise about the net amount deposited. We haven't modeled withholding or any other deductions.
- 18 **Morgan:** Right. Every amount in this reconciliation is gross. Keep the review in the private payroll channel and don't invent a tax rate or net deposit.
- 19 **Leila:** I'll show base rate twenty, regular rate twenty-two, four overtime hours, total gross one thousand twelve, and ninety-two gross remaining including the bonus.
- 20 **Morgan:** That is the corrected explanation under the stated assumptions. It doesn't determine anyone else's classification, bonus treatment, state-law entitlement, or actual payroll outcome.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. nondiscretionary bonus | 2. regular rate | 3. half-time premium | 4. gross earnings | 5. true-up | 6. payroll reconciliation

Recalculate another included bonus

F Say it in a new situation

Same simplified US FLSA assumptions: 46 worked hours at \$18/hour, plus a confirmed includable \$92 bonus earned entirely that week. Original gross already paid \$882: \$828 straight time plus \$54 overtime premium. Six overtime hours; bonus and true-up unpaid. No other pay components, deductions, or rules are modeled.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

60 / 980 / six / 20

10

Assistant: The regular rate is ¹ _____ dollars per hour.

Reviewer: The corrected additional half-time premium totals ² _____ dollars.

Assistant: Corrected total gross is ³ _____ dollars.

Reviewer: Beyond the unpaid bonus, the overtime true-up is ⁴ _____ dollars.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. 20 | 2. 60 | 3. 980 | 4. six

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Age the balance from the due date

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain an aged-receivables report using the correct date basis and outstanding amount.

Fictional report: aging date and balance cutoff both October 31. Due-date aging; overdue starts the day after the due date. Buckets: current, 1-30 days, 31-60 days. A: issued September 1, due October 1, \$500 invoice with \$100 already applied, \$400 open. B: issued September 30, due October 30, \$300 open. C: issued October 1, due November 15, \$200 open. No other items or later receipts.

PEOPLE / Ava: Receivables clerk | Luis: Account manager

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

open balance / control total / current balance / aging date / due-date basis / aging bucket

11

- 01 **Luis:** Invoice A was issued on September first. At October thirty-first, that looks sixty days old, so I've put its five hundred dollars in the thirty-one-to-sixty column.
- 02 **Ava:** This report uses the ¹ _____, not issue-date age. A was due October first, so it's thirty days past due, not sixty.
- 03 **Luis:** Then October second is day one overdue, and October thirty-first is day thirty. It belongs in the one-to-thirty bucket.
- 04 **Ava:** Yes. Keep the ² _____ visible as October thirty-first. We shouldn't let a later date change the explanation of this saved report.
- 05 **Luis:** What about the amount? A's invoice is five hundred, but a hundred has already been applied before the cutoff.
- 06 **Ava:** Age the ³ _____ of four hundred. The paid portion doesn't remain outstanding just because the original invoice still shows five hundred.
- 07 **Luis:** Invoice B is due October thirtieth, so on October thirty-first it's one day overdue. Its three hundred goes in the same bucket as A.
- 08 **Ava:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ includes both endpoints. Four hundred plus three hundred gives seven hundred in one-to-thirty days.
- 09 **Luis:** C was issued October first, but it isn't due until November fifteenth. Is its two hundred current even though the invoice is a month old?
- 10 **Ava:** Yes. A ⁵ _____ means not overdue under these report definitions. Issue-date age doesn't move that two hundred into an overdue bucket.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Luis:** Then the report totals two hundred current, seven hundred one-to-thirty, and zero thirty-one-to-sixty. Total open receivables are nine hundred.
- 12 **Ava:** That's the ⁶ _____ across the three items. It must match the sum of the buckets without adding A's applied hundred back in.
- 13 **Luis:** If we changed the report to age by document date, some buckets would change even if no customer paid another dollar.
- 14 **Ava:** Exactly. A changed basis can move balances between columns. That movement isn't automatically a deterioration in payment behavior or a new cash event.
- 15 **Luis:** And if someone runs the balance cutoff at a later date while keeping October thirty-first for aging, it may include different payment information.
- 16 **Ava:** Yes. That's why this case fixes both dates at October thirty-first. A comparison needs the same date settings or an explicit explanation of the difference.
- 17 **Luis:** Does being thirty days overdue mean A is automatically written off, or that a late fee has already been authorized?
- 18 **Ava:** No. This report classifies the supplied open balance. It doesn't establish a write-off, a fee, a collection action, or a credit-loss conclusion.
- 19 **Luis:** I'll correct A from five hundred at sixty days to four hundred at thirty days, and retain the stated dates beside the totals.
- 20 **Ava:** Good. Read back two hundred current, seven hundred one-to-thirty, zero thirty-one-to-sixty, total nine hundred. That describes the actual report rather than the age of the original paperwork.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. due-date basis | 2. aging date | 3. open balance | 4. aging bucket | 5. current balance | 6. control total

Check the bucket boundary

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional aging date and balance cutoff November 30; same due-date basis and inclusive buckets. D: due October 30, \$260 invoice less \$60 already applied. E: due November 30, \$150 open, not overdue on its due date. F: due November 15, \$90 open. No other entries.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

31 / 440 / current / 200

Clerk: D is ¹ _____ days past due.

Manager: D's open balance in that bucket is ² _____ dollars.

Clerk: E's \$150 belongs in the ³ _____ bucket.

Manager: Total open receivables are ⁴ _____ dollars.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 31 | 2. 200 | 3. current | 4. 440

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Matching an invoice to its supporting records

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What does invoice A184 bill?

A. Twelve desk lamps

The supplier invoice specifically bills twelve desk lamps.

2. What does receiving record R9 show?

A. Ten lamps

R9 records ten received, which differs from the invoice and order quantity.

3. What is known about the remaining two?

D. A second delivery is possible but unsupported by another record

The possibility of another delivery remains unverified because its receiving record is unavailable.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which summary is accurate?

B. A184 and P61 list twelve; R9 records ten; support for two is missing

The summary preserves the document-specific quantities and the unresolved evidence gap.

2. Which request moves the query forward?

A. Please locate any receiving record for the remaining two lamps

The missing evidence concerns receipt of the remaining two lamps.

3. What does may relate to another delivery mean?

C. It is a possible explanation requiring support

May marks a hypothesis rather than an established receiving fact.

4. Which reference belongs to the receiving record?

D. R9

R9 is explicitly the receiving record, while A184 and P61 identify other documents.

01 Conversation answers

Matching an invoice to its supporting records

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. document chain.** Turn 2. Document chain links invoice A184, order P61, and receiving record R9 so the precise mismatch is visible.
- 2. matching exception.** Turn 4. Matching exception arises because the invoice and order show twelve while the receiving record shows ten.
- 3. partial delivery.** Turn 6. Partial delivery is a possible context for the difference, but a later receipt still needs evidence.
- 4. supporting document.** Turn 8. Supporting document would provide evidence for any additional receipt rather than relying on an assumed delivery.
- 5. received quantity.** Turn 10. Received quantity documented in R9 is ten and must not be overwritten to force agreement with the other records.
- 6. overbilling.** Turn 12. Overbilling is not established by an unresolved receiving-record gap when another delivery remains possible.
- 7. quantity variance.** Turn 14. Quantity variance is two lamps between the billed and ordered twelve and the documented receipt of ten.
- 8. approval evidence.** Turn 16. Approval evidence is absent from the supplied facts, so the matching inquiry must not be described as payment authorization.
- 9. query status.** Turn 18. Query status should say whether the missing receipt support was found, not merely that someone handled the request.
- 10. unmatched balance.** Turn 20. Unmatched balance is the two-lamp portion not supported by the available receiving record, not a confirmed debt or loss.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. A184

Clerk: "The supplier invoice is A184."

A184 identifies the Alder invoice billing twelve desk lamps.

2. P61

Colleague: "The purchase order is P61."

P61 identifies the order for the same twelve lamps.

3. R9

Clerk: "Receiving record R9 lists ten."

R9 is the available receiving evidence and supports only ten lamps.

4. two

Colleague: "Support for the remaining two lamps is missing."

Two is the difference between twelve billed and ten documented as received.

02 Briefing and language checks

Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What is known about the \$600 receipt?

C. It belongs to Pine but lacks an invoice reference

The customer identity is known, but invoice allocation remains unresolved.

2. What do the two invoices total?

B. \$1,000

Six hundred plus four hundred gives a thousand dollars of stated invoice amounts.

3. Which invoice is confirmed settled?

B. Neither while allocation is pending

The ledger keeps both invoices open pending the missing allocation information.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement is accurate?

A. \$600 was received from Pine, but invoice allocation is pending

The known receipt and unresolved allocation must both remain visible.

2. What does the \$400 net difference establish?

B. The arithmetic across the stated invoices and receipt

The difference is account-level arithmetic and does not resolve invoice-specific application.

3. Which request is appropriate?

D. Please confirm the intended invoice reference or remittance details

The missing information concerns allocation, not whether the money arrived.

4. Why is a matching amount insufficient here?

A. The receipt has no invoice reference and allocation remains pending

The known facts explicitly leave application unresolved despite the equal amounts.

02 Conversation answers

Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. cash receipt.** Turn 2. Cash receipt confirms six hundred dollars from Pine, even though its invoice application is unresolved.
- 2. open invoice.** Turn 4. Open invoice describes an unsettled ledger item while the identified receipt awaits allocation.
- 3. matching amount.** Turn 6. Matching amount is a clue, but the missing reference prevents it from proving the intended invoice application.
- 4. remittance advice.** Turn 8. Remittance advice can identify the invoice or invoices Pine intended the payment to settle.
- 5. net difference.** Turn 10. Net difference is four hundred dollars after comparing the thousand-dollar invoice total with the six-hundred-dollar receipt.
- 6. invoice-level balance.** Turn 12. Invoice-level balance depends on the actual allocation, which cannot be inferred from the overall four-hundred-dollar difference.
- 7. allocation query.** Turn 14. Allocation query asks where the existing receipt belongs, rather than demanding a second payment.
- 8. overdue.** Turn 16. Overdue requires an applicable due date, which has not been supplied in this case.
- 9. customer account.** Turn 18. Customer account groups Pine's two invoices and identified receipt while preserving their separate allocation states.
- 10. allocation instruction.** Turn 20. Allocation instruction identifies the intended application and is the missing information needed for the next review.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. 600

Clerk: "The identified receipt is 600 dollars."

Six hundred dollars has been identified as Pine's receipt, not as a missing payment.

2. 1000

Customer: "The two invoices total 1000 dollars."

One thousand is the sum of invoice 410 at six hundred and 411 at four hundred.

3. 400

Clerk: "The net difference across these items is 400 dollars."

Four hundred is the arithmetic difference, not a confirmed invoice-specific allocation.

4. allocation

Customer: "The receipt still needs allocation."

Allocation remains pending because the receipt has no intended invoice reference.

03 Briefing and language checks

Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which balance is lower at June 30?

A. The bank balance by \$300

The brief explicitly states that the bank balance is three hundred dollars below the ledger.

2. When does the deposit appear in bank activity?

B. July 1

The deposit is in the June 30 ledger but appears in bank activity on July 1.

3. What is the status of the broader reconciliation?

C. Other checks remain incomplete

The supplied facts leave other reconciliation checks unfinished.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which explanation has the correct direction?

D. The June 30 ledger includes \$300 that appears at the bank July 1

The earlier ledger entry is consistent with the bank being lower at the June cutoff.

2. Why should the deposit not simply be entered again?

A. It is already recorded in the cash ledger

The ledger already contains the deposit, so timing alone does not justify recording it again.

3. Which completion statement is accurate?

B. The timing item is supported, but other checks remain open

The brief leaves other checks incomplete despite the matching deposit evidence.

4. Which evidence supports this cutoff explanation?

C. The June 30 ledger deposit linked to its July 1 bank appearance

The two linked dated records explain when the same deposit appears on each side; neither a duplicate posting nor an undated balance claim supplies that evidence.

03 Conversation answers

Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. timing difference.** Turn 2. Timing difference is supported by the deposit appearing in the June 30 ledger and July 1 bank activity.
- 2. reconciliation cutoff.** Turn 4. Reconciliation cutoff is June 30, so the July 1 bank entry belongs to subsequent activity.
- 3. deposit in transit.** Turn 6. Deposit in transit describes the deposit recorded in the books but not yet in the bank record at the cutoff.
- 4. review status.** Turn 8. Review status remains incomplete because other reconciliation checks have not been finished.
- 5. reconciling item.** Turn 10. Reconciling item is the identified deposit timing difference, not proof that the entire review is complete.
- 6. cash ledger.** Turn 12. Cash ledger already includes the June 30 deposit, so timing alone does not justify entering the same deposit again.
- 7. ledger adjustment.** Turn 14. Ledger adjustment is a separate posting decision and is not automatically required by this timing evidence.
- 8. bank activity.** Turn 16. Bank activity on July 1 is the subsequent record supporting the deposit's later bank appearance.
- 9. direction of difference.** Turn 18. Direction of difference is bank below ledger by three hundred dollars, not the reverse.
- 10. Reconciliation sign-off.** Turn 20. Reconciliation sign-off has not been established while other required checks remain unfinished.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. lower

Bookkeeper: "At June 30, the bank is \$300 lower than the ledger."

Lower preserves the stated direction of the difference at the cutoff.

2. 30

Colleague: "The deposit is recorded in the ledger on June 30."

June 30 is the ledger date, before the deposit appears in bank activity.

3. 1

Bookkeeper: "It appears at the bank on July 1."

July 1 is the subsequent bank date supporting the timing explanation.

4. incomplete

Colleague: "Other reconciliation checks remain incomplete."

Incomplete prevents the supported timing item from becoming a false claim of full reconciliation.

04 Briefing and language checks

Requesting evidence for time exceptions

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is missing from Tuesday's timecard?

A. A clock-out entry

The timecard lacks the end-of-work entry, while other information is separately available.

2. How do the two time sources differ?

A. Roster says 17:00; Eli recalls 17:30

The roster and employee recollection give different times, neither yet confirmed as actual.

3. What can Hana review before 14:00?

A. The work log

The brief identifies the work log as evidence the supervisor can review before the internal cutoff.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which exception note is accurate?

A. Missing Tuesday clock-out; roster 17:00; Eli recalls 17:30; actual finish unconfirmed

The note preserves the missing entry, both attributed sources, and unresolved actual time.

2. What should Hana be asked to do?

B. Review the work log and report the supported finding

The supplied next step is evidence review by the supervisor.

3. Which statement about 14:00 is correct?

D. It is the fictional internal approval cutoff

The deadline concerns today's review process, not Tuesday's actual work time.

4. What should accompany an authorized correction?

D. The evidence and review trail

A traceable correction retains the basis and status of the change.

04 Conversation answers

Requesting evidence for time exceptions

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. source attribution.** Turn 2. Source attribution keeps the roster's 17:00 and Eli's recollection of 17:30 attached to their distinct origins.
- 2. actual finish.** Turn 4. Actual finish is unconfirmed because the available schedule and recollection have not yet been verified against the work evidence.
- 3. work log.** Turn 6. Work log is the available evidence Hana can examine before the internal approval cutoff.
- 4. scheduled finish.** Turn 8. Scheduled finish is the roster's planned 17:00 time, not verified evidence of when Eli actually stopped work.
- 5. time exception.** Turn 10. Time exception describes the missing or inconsistent record without accusing Eli or proving that no work occurred.
- 6. review outcome.** Turn 12. Review outcome is the finding from examining the evidence, not the fact that Hana has started looking.
- 7. internal cutoff.** Turn 14. Internal cutoff is the organization's fictional review deadline and does not determine employee pay rights.
- 8. audit trail.** Turn 16. Audit trail records the evidence, review, and authorized change rather than hiding the original missing entry.
- 9. payroll handoff.** Turn 18. Payroll handoff carries the record gap, source-specific times, pending evidence review, and internal deadline together.
- 10. approval status.** Turn 20. Approval status remains unresolved until the relevant review and authorization establish any correction.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. clock-out

Assistant: "The missing entry is Tuesday's clock-out."

Clock-out is the absent end-of-work entry on the timecard.

2. 17:00

Supervisor: "The roster gives 17:00."

17:00 is the planned finish, not the verified actual time.

3. 17:30

Assistant: "Eli recalls 17:30."

17:30 is Eli's attributed recollection and remains subject to evidence review.

4. 14:00

Supervisor: "The internal review cutoff is 14:00 today."

14:00 is today's processing deadline, not a determination of actual hours or pay rights.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Explaining a payroll preview

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What stays the same in both previews?

B. Gross pay of \$1,200

Both previews show gross pay of twelve hundred dollars.

2. Why is B's net pay \$50 lower arithmetically?

A. Deductions increase from \$200 to \$250

The deduction total rises fifty dollars while gross pay stays unchanged.

3. What remains pending?

A. Support for the new \$50 deduction

The supporting record for the new deduction line has not yet been supplied.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which calculation matches preview B?

B. \$1,200 minus \$250 equals \$950

Preview B retains the twelve-hundred-dollar gross and subtracts two hundred fifty.

2. Which explanation is accurate?

B. Net falls because deductions rise, while gross remains unchanged

The supplied arithmetic establishes the movement but not the new line's purpose or authority.

3. Which reply addresses Morgan's unresolved question?

A. I will verify the new \$50 line's purpose and authority from its supporting record

Morgan needs the basis for the new deduction, not only another subtraction; its purpose, authority, and any correction remain unestablished.

4. Which statement overclaims?

D. The new line is authorized because it appears in the preview

Appearance in a preliminary calculation does not establish the deduction's valid basis.

05 Conversation answers

Explaining a payroll preview

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. gross pay.** Turn 2. Gross pay remains twelve hundred dollars in both previews, so the supplied figures do not show a gross-pay cut.
- 2. deduction total.** Turn 4. Deduction total is two hundred dollars in A and two hundred fifty in B.
- 3. gross-to-net.** Turn 6. Gross-to-net explanation connects unchanged gross pay, increased deductions, and the resulting lower net amount.
- 4. deduction line.** Turn 8. Deduction line is visible in preview B, but its purpose and supporting basis have not been supplied.
- 5. payroll preview.** Turn 10. Payroll preview is a preliminary calculation and does not by itself prove approval of every line.
- 6. payroll query.** Turn 12. Payroll query concerns the basis of the new fifty-dollar deduction, not the subtraction itself.
- 7. supporting record.** Turn 14. Supporting record is the missing evidence needed to explain the new deduction's basis and status.
- 8. final payroll.** Turn 16. Final payroll has not been established by comparing these preliminary records with unresolved supporting documentation.
- 9. correction status.** Turn 18. Correction status is not yet a completed change or refund; the current action is a private supporting-record query.
- 10. variance explanation.** Turn 20. Variance explanation states the numerical movement while retaining the unresolved basis of the new deduction.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 1200

Assistant: "Gross pay remains 1200 dollars."

Twelve hundred is unchanged in both payroll previews.

2. 250

Employee: "Preview B shows 250 dollars in deductions."

Two hundred fifty is B's deduction total, fifty more than A.

3. 950

Assistant: "That leaves 950 dollars net in B."

Nine hundred fifty is twelve hundred less two hundred fifty.

4. pending

Employee: "The supporting record is still pending."

Pending preserves the unresolved basis of the new deduction rather than declaring it authorized.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Making approval status unambiguous

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. How many invoices have recorded approval?

C. Seven

Seven of the eight invoices have recorded approval in the supplied payment set.

2. Why is V22 excluded from the proposal?

D. Its receiving document is missing

V22 awaits receiving evidence and is not part of the proposed seven-item batch.

3. What does 15:00 establish?

D. The approver's return time

The stated time concerns availability of the approver, not a completed payment decision.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which status line is accurate?

B. Seven invoices approved; V22 excluded; proposed batch unreleased

The correct line preserves item approval, exclusion, proposal, and release status.

2. What would overstate the meaning of 15:00?

C. Payments are guaranteed to be sent at 15:00

Return time does not guarantee an approval or payment-release outcome.

3. Which count belongs to the proposed batch?

A. Seven

The proposal excludes V22 and therefore contains the seven other invoices.

4. What information is still needed for V22?

A. The receiving document

V22 is explicitly awaiting evidence of receipt before the exception can be resolved.

06 Conversation answers

Making approval status unambiguous

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. recorded approval. Turn 2. Recorded approval applies to seven invoices, not all eight in the original payment set.

2. batch membership. Turn 4. Batch membership is seven items because V22 has been excluded from the proposal.

3. release status. Turn 6. Release status remains unreleased even though the seven included invoices have recorded approval.

4. receiving evidence. Turn 8. Receiving evidence is the missing document for V22 and explains its exclusion from the proposed batch.

5. return time. Turn 10. Return time is 15:00 for the approver, not a guaranteed batch-release or payment time.

6. control stage. Turn 12. Control stage distinguishes the unreleased proposal from invoice approval and later payment execution.

7. excluded item. Turn 14. Excluded item identifies V22 as outside the proposed seven-item batch while its receiving document is pending.

8. exception item. Turn 16. Exception item keeps V22 active for follow-up without treating exclusion as cancellation or permanent rejection.

9. approval trail. Turn 18. Approval trail records the actual permissions without substituting them for uncompleted release or payment stages.

10. supplier update. Turn 20. Supplier update should report the supported process stage without promising that payment has been sent or will arrive at a set time.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. seven

Preparer: "The number of approved invoices is seven."

Seven invoices have recorded approval in the original eight-item set.

2. V22

Colleague: "The excluded invoice is V22."

V22 is left out because its receiving document is still missing.

3. released

Preparer: "The batch has not been released."

Released names the separate stage that the proposed batch has not completed.

4. 15:00

Colleague: "The approver returns at 15:00."

15:00 is the return time, not a guaranteed release or supplier-payment time.

07 Briefing and language checks

Handing over a period-close review

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. How many checklist items are complete?

B. Nine of ten

Nine items are complete, with one period-close review still outstanding.

2. What dates differ on the maintenance item?

B. Invoice dated July 2; service described as June

The document date and stated service period fall in different months.

3. What does Alex take over at noon?

A. Follow-up on the open item

Alex takes over follow-up while the accountant's period review and entry approval remain unresolved.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which handoff preserves the facts?

D. \$240 invoice dated July 2 for June service; accountant review pending

The summary separates amount, document date, service period, and unresolved review.

2. What does nine of ten complete mean?

C. One checklist item remains open

The completion count leaves one required checklist item unfinished.

3. Which responsibility changes at noon?

A. Alex takes over follow-up

The brief assigns follow-up ownership rather than authority for an accounting decision.

4. Which statement is unsupported?

B. The adjusting entry has already been approved

No adjusting entry has been approved in the supplied close status.

07 Conversation answers

Handing over a period-close review

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. close status.** Turn 2. Close status is nine of ten checklist items complete, not a fully finished June close.
- 2. invoice date.** Turn 4. Invoice date is July 2, separate from the June service period described on the document.
- 3. cutoff question.** Turn 6. Cutoff question concerns the appropriate posting period for a July-dated invoice describing June service.
- 4. posting approval.** Turn 8. Posting approval has not been given for an adjusting entry, even though the invoice amount is known.
- 5. follow-up owner.** Turn 10. Follow-up owner is Alex from noon, responsible for pursuing the review rather than approving the accounting entry.
- 6. cutoff evidence.** Turn 12. Cutoff evidence includes the July 2 document date and June service description needed for the accountant's review.
- 7. open item.** Turn 14. Open item remains incomplete after ownership transfers because the accountant's review is still pending.
- 8. accountant review.** Turn 16. Accountant review must be reported according to its actual outcome, not assumed to include posting approval.
- 9. adjusting entry.** Turn 18. Adjusting entry is a possible accounting action requiring the relevant review and approval, not something authorized by this handoff.
- 10. handover time.** Turn 20. Handover time is noon, when follow-up responsibility passes to Alex without completing or approving the open item.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. 240

Bookkeeper: "The maintenance invoice is for 240 dollars."

Two hundred forty is the stated amount of the invoice awaiting period review.

2. June

Colleague: "Its description refers to June service."

June is the service period, despite the July 2 document date.

3. accountant

Bookkeeper: "The accountant must review the posting period."

Accountant is the required reviewer, not automatically the follow-up owner.

4. open

Colleague: "One checklist item remains open."

Open preserves the unfinished review even after Alex takes responsibility for follow-up.

08 Briefing and language checks

Correcting records while preserving the trail

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What has the controller confirmed?

B. One duplicate tracker entry for J14

The verified issue is a duplicate entry caused by importing the same file twice.

2. What is the current ledger-correction status?

C. No correction has been posted

The supplied facts explicitly state that no ledger correction has been posted.

3. Which earlier claim is wrong?

C. The duplicate payment had been recovered

No duplicate payment is established, so the recovery statement is unsupported.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which correction is accurate?

D. One J14 tracker duplicate is confirmed; no duplicate payment or recovery is established

The statement preserves the verified record issue and withdraws the unsupported cash claim.

2. What does twice \$180 establish here?

A. The duplicate tracker rows sum to \$360

The calculation concerns two working-record entries, not proven payment or ledger events.

3. Which action preserves the trail?

A. Link the explicit correction to the original message and supporting records

A traceable correction retains the connection between the error, evidence, and authorized amendment.

4. Which status remains uncompleted?

B. Ledger correction posting

The supplied facts confirm the duplicate but explicitly leave ledger correction unposted.

08 Conversation answers

Correcting records while preserving the trail

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. verified finding. Turn 2. Verified finding is one duplicate J14 entry in tracker version 3, not a recovered payment.

2. duplicate entry. Turn 4. Duplicate entry is a repeated record of J14 and does not prove a second actual payment.

3. working total. Turn 6. Working total is the sum of the duplicate tracker rows, not a verified cash or ledger balance.

4. posted correction. Turn 8. Posted correction would be an actual ledger change, and none has occurred in the supplied status.

5. retraction. Turn 10. Retraction explicitly withdraws the unsupported claim that a duplicate payment was recovered.

6. payment recovery. Turn 12. Payment recovery would require evidence that money was returned, which is not established here.

7. correction trail. Turn 14. Correction trail links the original false statement, explicit correction, and evidence rather than silently erasing history.

8. import log. Turn 16. Import log can support the confirmed repeated file import and should remain connected to the review.

9. Change authorization. Turn 18. Change authorization is required for the actual amendment and is not created by correcting a message.

10. status correction. Turn 20. Status correction replaces the unsupported recovery claim with the verified duplicate-entry finding and unresolved ledger status.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. J14

Bookkeeper: "The invoice reference is J14."

J14 identifies the invoice duplicated in tracker version 3.

2. 180

Controller: "The invoice amount is 180 dollars."

One hundred eighty is the invoice amount, not a proven recovered payment.

3. entry

Bookkeeper: "One duplicate tracker entry is confirmed."

Entry describes the verified repeated record without asserting a duplicate cash payment.

4. posted

Controller: "No ledger correction has been posted."

Posted is the accounting stage explicitly not completed in the supplied status.

08

09 Conversation answers

Paid once, expensed over time

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. prepaid expense. Turn 2. The payment covers future support service; the specified accounting treatment initially carries the unconsumed cost as an asset rather than treating each later expense as a new payment.

2. recognition schedule. Turn 4. The accountant specifies twelve equal monthly amounts across July through June, so \$1,200 divided by twelve is \$100 per month, not a six-month allocation.

3. cumulative expense. Turn 6. Three months at \$100 each produce \$300 cumulative expense through September; that is not the amount to add if July and August are already posted.

4. current-period adjustment. Turn 8. Only September's \$100 remains to be recognized; adding \$300 again would repeat the \$200 already posted for July and August.

5. carrying amount. Turn 10. After recognizing \$300 of the \$1,200 cost, the remaining prepaid asset is \$900 under the supplied schedule; it is not a bank balance or a refund claim.

6. noncash adjustment. Turn 12. Recognizing the used portion reduces the prepaid asset and increases expense without another cash payment; the original \$1,200 cash outflow occurred in July.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 600

Manager: Expense through June should total 600 dollars.

April, May, and June are three months at \$200, totaling \$600 cumulatively.

2. 200

Bookkeeper: Only 200 dollars remains for June recognition.

The \$400 for April and May is already posted, so the incremental June amount is \$200, not \$600.

3. 1800

Manager: The proposed prepaid balance after June is 1800 dollars.

The original \$2,400 less \$600 cumulative expense leaves \$1,800 of unconsumed service.

4. no

Bookkeeper: The June allocation requires no additional cash payment.

The service was paid in advance; recognizing June's portion is not another supplier payment.

Background reading: [OpenStax: prepaid expense recognition and noncash period adjustments](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

The bonus changes the regular rate

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. nondiscretionary bonus. Turn 2. The supplied production bonus is includable in the regular rate and earned entirely in this workweek, so it changes the overtime calculation as well as adding eighty-eight dollars.

2. regular rate. Turn 4. The includable straight-time earnings plus bonus are \$968; dividing by all forty-four worked hours gives a \$22 regular rate, not the \$20 base rate.

3. half-time premium. Turn 6. With straight time for every worked hour already included, the additional overtime premium is half of the \$22 regular rate, or \$11 for each of four overtime hours.

4. gross earnings. Turn 8. The \$968 straight-time-plus-bonus amount plus \$44 overtime premium totals \$1,012 gross, before taxes or other deductions.

5. true-up. Turn 10. The corrected premium is \$44, of which \$40 was already paid; the additional overtime amount is \$4, separate from the still-unpaid \$88 bonus.

6. payroll reconciliation. Turn 12. The original \$920 gross plus the \$88 unpaid bonus and \$4 premium difference equals the corrected \$1,012 total; neither the full premium nor the original pay is paid twice.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. 20

Assistant: The regular rate is 20 dollars per hour.

Straight time \$828 plus bonus \$92 equals \$920; dividing by forty-six hours gives \$20, not the \$18 base rate.

2. 60

Reviewer: The corrected additional half-time premium totals 60 dollars.

Half of the \$20 regular rate is \$10; six overtime hours therefore require \$60 premium in total.

3. 980

Assistant: Corrected total gross is 980 dollars.

The \$920 straight-time-plus-bonus amount plus \$60 premium equals \$980 gross.

4. six

Reviewer: Beyond the unpaid bonus, the overtime true-up is six dollars.

The corrected \$60 premium less the \$54 already paid leaves \$6 extra, not another full \$60.

10

Background reading: [US Department of Labor: Fact Sheet 56C, included bonuses and the regular rate](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Age the balance from the due date

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. due-date basis. Turn 2. The report ages from the due date, not the issue date; A is due October 1 and is thirty days past due on October 31.

2. aging date. Turn 4. October 31 is the fixed date against which overdue days are measured; using today's date or the invoice issue date would change the report's meaning.

3. open balance. Turn 6. A's original \$500 invoice less the \$100 already applied leaves \$400 outstanding; the aging bucket must contain \$400, not the full original invoice amount.

4. aging bucket. Turn 8. The stated 1-30-day bucket includes both one and thirty days; A's \$400 and B's \$300 therefore total \$700 in that bucket.

5. current balance. Turn 10. C is not yet due at the October 31 aging date, so its \$200 is current despite having an October 1 issue date.

6. control total. Turn 12. The three open balances are \$400, \$300, and \$200, totaling \$900; the bucket amounts must reconcile to that same total without adding the applied \$100 again.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 31

Clerk: D is 31 days past due.

From October 30 to November 30 is thirty-one days; overdue begins October 31, placing D in the 31-60 bucket.

2. 200

Manager: D's open balance in that bucket is 200 dollars.

The \$260 invoice less the \$60 applied payment leaves \$200 outstanding.

3. current

Clerk: E's \$150 belongs in the current bucket.

An item due on November 30 is not yet overdue on that same date under the supplied rule.

4. 440

Manager: Total open receivables are 440 dollars.

D \$200 plus E \$150 plus F \$90 equals \$440; the already-applied \$60 is not added back.

11

Background reading: [Microsoft Learn: customer aging dates, balances, and date criteria](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Matching an invoice to its supporting records

Identify the invoice: I am querying Alder invoice A184.

State the order quantity: The purchase order also lists twelve.

Request the missing support: Can you locate a second receiving record?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Explaining receipts and outstanding customer balances

Acknowledge receipt: We have identified your \$600 receipt.

Explain the ledger status: Both invoices remain open pending allocation.

Qualify an amount match: The receipt matches 410 in amount, but that does not confirm allocation.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Qualifying a bank reconciliation difference

Name the cutoff: This reconciliation is through June 30.

Identify the bank date: It appears in the bank activity on July 1.

Avoid reversing the difference: The bank is lower, not higher, at June 30.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Requesting evidence for time exceptions

Identify the exception: Tuesday's timecard is missing a clock-out.

State the unresolved fact: The actual finish time is not confirmed.

Avoid defaulting to memory: The recollection needs to remain attributed.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Explaining a payroll preview

Acknowledge the concern: You are asking why preview B shows less net pay.

Explain preview B: B shows \$250 in deductions and \$950 net.

Name the evidence gap: The supporting record is still pending.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Making approval status unambiguous

Identify the original set: We began with eight invoices.

State the exclusion: V22 is excluded from the proposed batch.

Avoid a payment claim: We have no confirmation that payment has been sent.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Handing over a period-close review

State the close position: Nine of ten checklist items are complete.

Give the document date: It is dated July 2.

Preserve approval status: No adjusting entry has been approved.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Correcting records while preserving the trail

Identify the record: This concerns tracker version 3 and invoice J14.

Name the verified finding: The controller confirmed one duplicate entry.

Own the earlier error: My previous message said the duplicate payment had been recovered.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

account-level position	explain the account-level position	14
accountant review	obtain accountant review	59
accounts payable	raise an accounts payable query	5
accounts receivable	check accounts receivable	14
accrual	discuss an accrual question	59
accrued expense	identify an accrued-expense review	59
actual finish	verify the actual finish	32
adjusted balance	verify the adjusted balance	24
adjusting entry	distinguish an adjusting entry	59
aging bucket	reconcile the aging buckets	15
allocation instruction	record the allocation instruction	15
allocation query	raise an allocation query	15
approval dependency	state the approval dependency	50
approval evidence	obtain approval evidence	6
approval status	report approval status	32
approval trail	retain the approval trail	51
approver	contact the approver	50
audit trail	preserve the audit trail	33
authorization limit	preserve the authorization limit	51
bank activity	check subsequent bank activity	23
bank balance	identify the bank balance	23
bank charge	identify a bank charge	24
bank reconciliation	prepare a bank reconciliation	23
batch count	reconcile the batch count	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

batch membership confirm batch membership	51
batch proposal distinguish the batch proposal	50
batch release distinguish batch release	50
carrying amount reconcile the carrying amount	60
cash ledger compare the cash ledger	23
cash movement confirm cash movement	69
cash receipt acknowledge the cash receipt	14
change authorization obtain change authorization	69
clock-in verify the clock-in	32
clock-out query a missing clock-out	32
close checklist update the close checklist	59
close status report close status	60
collection message correct a misleading collection message	15
completion claim qualify a completion claim	24
control stage identify the control stage	51
controller obtain controller confirmation	68
correction owner identify the correction owner	69
correction status report correction status	42
correction trail preserve the correction trail	69
credit balance verify a credit balance	15
cross-reference include a cross-reference	69
customer account identify the customer account	14
cutoff evidence retain cutoff evidence	60
cutoff question raise a cutoff question	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

days past due calculate days past due	15
deduction identify a deduction	41
deduction authority verify deduction authority	42
deduction line query a new deduction line	41
deduction total compare deduction totals	41
deposit trace the deposit	23
deposit in transit identify a deposit in transit	23
direction of difference state the direction of difference	24
document chain preserve the document chain	6
duplicate entry confirm a duplicate entry	68
duplicate import identify a duplicate import	68
duplicate payment distinguish a duplicate payment	68
earnings line distinguish an earnings line	41
employee recollection record the employee recollection	32
exception item track the exception item	51
exception queue maintain the exception queue	33
excluded item identify the excluded item	50
final payroll distinguish a preview from final payroll	42
follow-up owner name the follow-up owner	60
general ledger distinguish the general ledger	60
gross pay state gross pay	41
gross-to-net explain gross-to-net movement	42
handover time confirm the handover time	60
import log consult the import log	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

interest credit distinguish an interest credit	24
internal cutoff meet the internal cutoff	32
invoice approval verify invoice approval	50
invoice date identify the invoice date	59
invoice quantity verify invoice quantity	5
invoice reference quote the invoice reference	6
invoice reference request the invoice reference	14
invoice-level balance distinguish an invoice-level balance	14
journal entry review the journal entry	60
ledger check the ledger	14
ledger adjustment distinguish a ledger adjustment	24
ledger balance distinguish the ledger balance	23
ledger correction distinguish a ledger correction	68
line item check the line item	5
maintenance expense identify the maintenance expense	59
matching amount distinguish a matching amount	15
matching exception document the matching exception	5
net difference calculate the net difference	15
net pay explain net pay	41
nondiscretionary bonus review a nondiscretionary bonus	42
open invoice explain an open invoice	14
open item retain the open item	59
order quantity compare order quantity	5
order reference retain the order reference	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

outstanding check distinguish an outstanding check	24
overbilling avoid assuming overbilling	6
overdue avoid assuming overdue status	15
overstatement correct an overstatement	69
partial delivery investigate a partial delivery	6
pay component identify the pay component	41
pay period identify the pay period	33
pay run identify the pay run	41
pay statement read the pay statement	41
payer identity verify payer identity	15
payment batch prepare a payment batch	50
payment confirmation request payment confirmation	50
payment execution verify payment execution	50
payment hold distinguish a payment hold	6
payment recovery verify payment recovery	68
payment status clarify payment status	51
payroll handoff complete the payroll handoff	33
payroll preview compare payroll previews	41
payroll query raise a payroll query	42
payroll register check the payroll register	41
pending evidence identify pending evidence	51
period close hand over the period close	59
posted correction verify a posted correction	68
posting approval verify posting approval	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

posting date compare posting dates	23
posting period request posting-period review	59
prepayment distinguish a prepayment	60
preview comparison prepare a preview comparison	42
purchase order match the purchase order	5
quantity variance explain the quantity variance	6
query status preserve query status	6
receipt allocation confirm receipt allocation	14
receipt reference include the receipt reference	6
received quantity preserve received quantity	5
receiving evidence obtain receiving evidence	50
receiving record check the receiving record	5
recognition schedule review the recognition schedule	60
reconciliation cutoff state the reconciliation cutoff	23
reconciliation evidence retain reconciliation evidence	24
reconciliation sign-off obtain reconciliation sign-off	24
reconciling item document a reconciling item	23
record retention follow record-retention procedures	69
recorded approval confirm recorded approval	50
recording error investigate a recording error	24
regular rate of pay verify the regular rate	42
release status report release status	51
remittance advice request remittance advice	14
remittance notice verify a remittance notice	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

reported hours qualify reported hours	33
resolution evidence request resolution evidence	69
retraction make a precise retraction	69
return time state the return time	50
review outcome record the review outcome	33
review status preserve review status	24
roster distinguish the roster	32
scheduled finish identify the scheduled finish	32
scheduled hours separate scheduled hours	33
service period distinguish the service period	59
settlement confirm invoice settlement	14
source attribution preserve source attribution	33
source file preserve the source file	68
statement of account clarify the statement of account	15
status correction issue a status correction	69
status readback give a status readback	51
statutory deduction distinguish a statutory deduction	42
subsequent activity inspect subsequent activity	23
supervisor review request supervisor review	32
supplier account identify the supplier account	6
supplier invoice identify the supplier invoice	5
supplier update qualify a supplier update	51
supporting document request the supporting document	5
supporting invoice attach the supporting invoice	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

supporting record request the supporting record	41
three-way match investigate a three-way match exception	5
time correction document a time correction	33
time exception raise a time exception	32
timecard check the timecard	32
timesheet approval distinguish timesheet approval	33
timing difference explain a timing difference	23
tracker identify the tracker	68
tracker version specify tracker version	68
transaction reference retain the transaction reference	69
unallocated receipt explain the unallocated receipt	14
unapplied cash identify unapplied cash	15
unit price verify the unit price	5
unmatched balance explain the unmatched balance	6
unposted item identify an unposted item	60
unreconciled difference report an unreconciled difference	24
unverified entry avoid an unverified entry	33
variance explanation give a variance explanation	42
verified finding report the verified finding	68
verified hours distinguish verified hours	33
voluntary deduction verify a voluntary deduction	42
withholding distinguish withholding from gross pay	42
work log review the work log	32
working total qualify a working total	69

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Bookkeeping, Accounting, and Auditing Clerks.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for financial records, posting, accuracy checks, and reconciliation. No source examples or statistical forecasts are reproduced. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] US Department of Labor. Fact Sheet 21: Recordkeeping.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on accurate time and pay records. The fictional cutoff is an internal review time, not a legal pay rule. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] OpenStax. Financial Accounting, section 8.6: Bank Reconciliation.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology reference for timing differences and reconciliation. The book uses original figures and dialogues, not the source exercises or diagrams. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] OpenStax. Financial Accounting, section 4.1: Adjusting Entries.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for accounting periods and adjustment terminology. The fictional close item remains subject to accountant review, with no posting instruction. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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